



212. A section of the wall of the Burj el-Malih fortress. Note the good masonry with coarse ashlar stones. 1988.



Site 90: 19 – 19/42/1

Khirbet el-Meiyiteh

Israel grid: 1942 1925

UTM grid: 7320 5797

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: medium sized ruin

Area: 7.8 dunams (1.95 acres)

Topography: ravine and ridge

Rock type: 'Arad formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and Colluvial – Alluvial; quality:

4

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Meiyiteh, no. 86), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site

Visibility: 3

Jan. 9, 1983; May 29, 1992; more visits; 70 shards and 903 flint items.

A site on an isolated, low hilltop in the valley of Wadi Malih, about 1 km east of Burj el-Malih. It is situated between Wadi el-Meiyiteh

(called here Wadi Lasm) and a tributary of it. 'Ain el-Meiyiteh, the water source of the site, is close to the place. East and west of the site

are cultivated fields.

In the west and south the place is protected by the steep slopes of Wadi el-Meiyiteh. At the same time, it is fortified by a wall of slightly hewn, medium sized stones discerned in the east and the north. The entrance was presumably through a gate in the northwestern corner where a section of the wall extend northward out from the main wall. On top of the ruin are piles of building stones, originating from the destroyed structures. The northeastern slope was fortified by

a glacis like, stone rampart. Plenty of shards are on the surface.

The site existed in the same period as that of el-Bird (site no. 91 here), south of Kh. el-Meiyiteh. It seems to be a unique example of a fortified site from Middle Bronze Age I.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Flint find: Natuffian (mainly); Pre-pottery Neolithic B, Chal, MBA I; see appendix.

Special find: Basalt vessels.

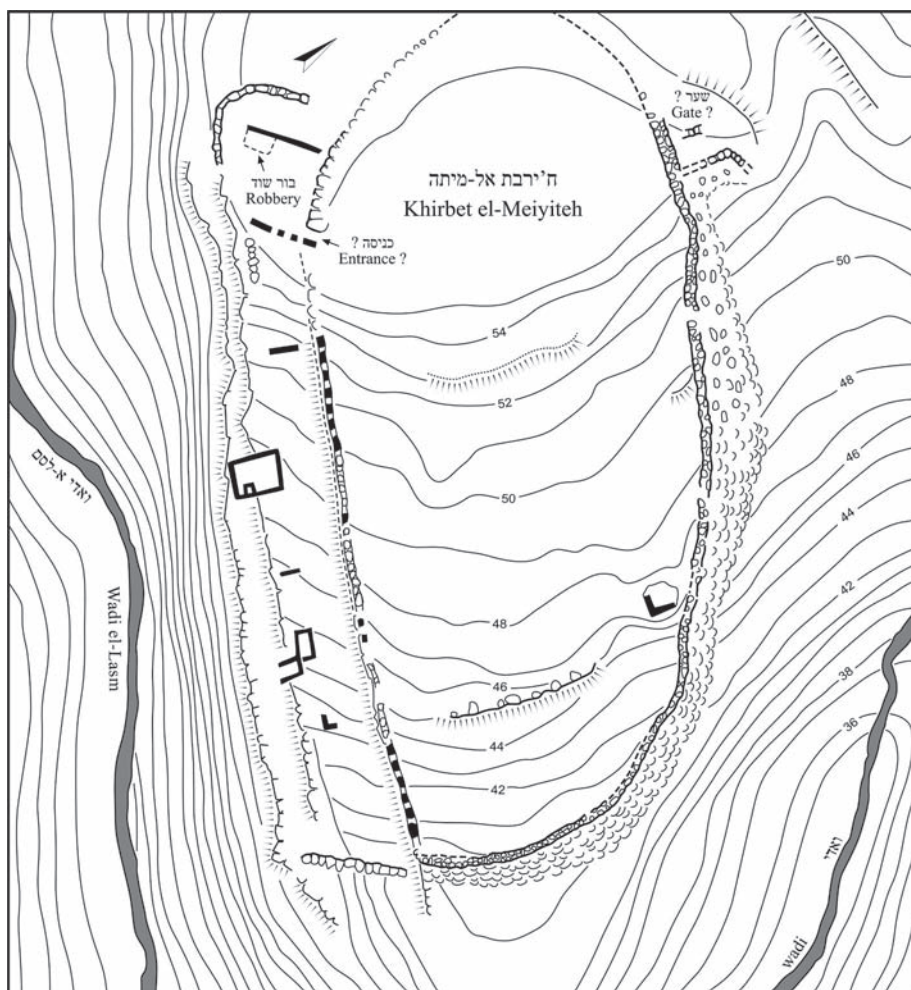
Previous surveys: none.



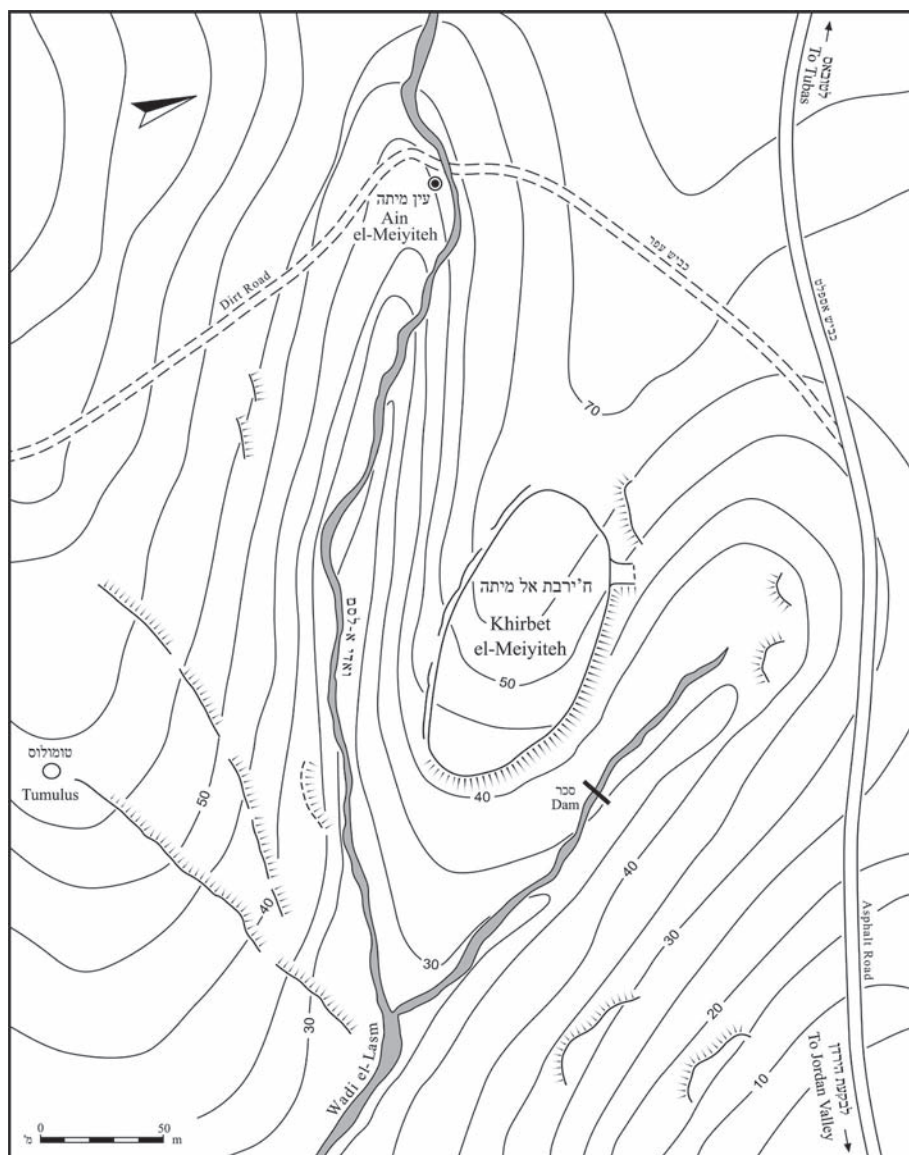
213. The fortified site of Kh. el-Meiyiteh, looking west. In the center are the site and its glacis. In the distant background are the hill and fortress of Burj el-Malih. Spring 1983.



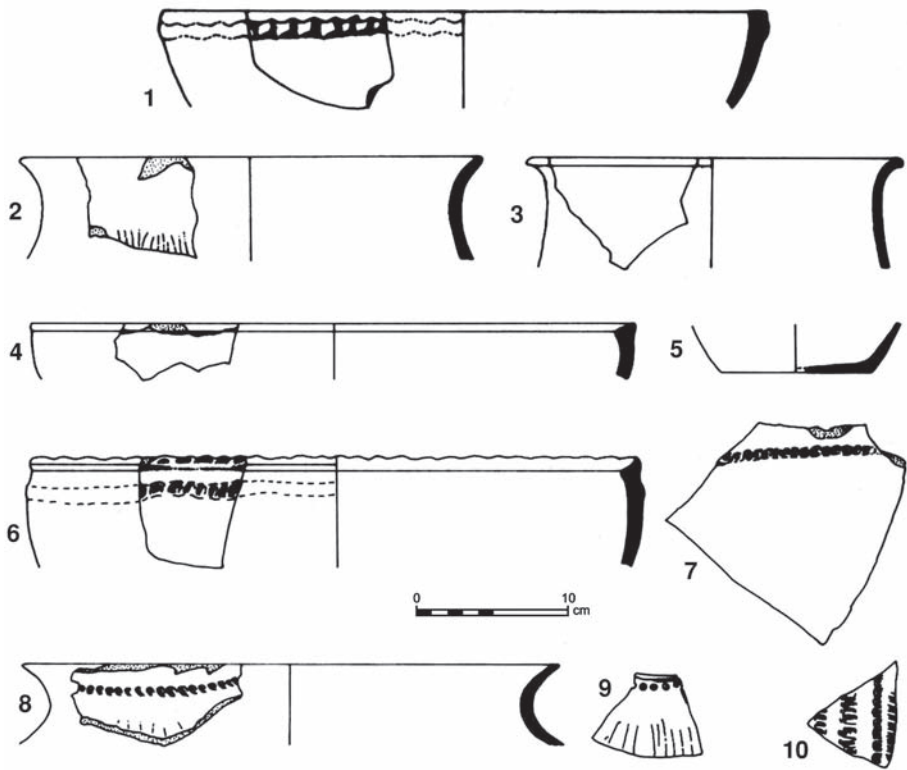
214. Aerial photo of the fortified site from Middle Bronze Age I at Kh. el-Meiyiteh, looking northwest. Left of the site are Wadi el-Lasm and 'Ain el-Meiyiteh and above the site is the road to Taiyasir (up) and to the Jordan Valley (down). Note the constructed rampart and remains of the wall.



215. Plan of the fortified site at Kh. el-Meiyyiteh. Note the remains of the glacis in the right. Winter 2006.



216. Kh. el-Meiyitch located within its surrounding. Winter 2006.



217. Pottery from the fortified Middle Bronze Age I site at Kh. el-Meiyiteh, all from this period: 1. Bowl, rope dec, dk; 2-3. Jars, yel; 4. Bowl, gray; 5. Small jar base, yel; 6. Bowl, reddish; 7. Rope dec, gray; 8. Jar with rope dec, gray; 9-10. Dec on shards of juglet and jar, yel.



218. Photos of pottery from Kh. el-Meiyiteh: 1-3. Rope dec; 4-5. Ledge handles; 6. Section of incense burner.

Site 91: 19 – 19/42/2

el-Bird (Ras Hamud)

Israel grid: 1943 1923

UTM grid: 7321 5795

Elevation: 80 m a.s.l., 60 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 18.5 dunams (4.6 acres)

Topography: ravine and ridge

Rock type: 'Arad formation

Soil type: Colluvial – Alluvial and

Mediterranean brown forest soil; qual-

ity: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Meiyiteh, no. 86), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Jan. 9, 1983 and additional visits; 66 shards

A large site on an isolated ridge, protected by deep wadis in the north and south. The road from Taiyasir to the Jordan Valley passes by some 0.5 km to the north. From the site there is a view only of the region of

Hamam el-Malih.

The site consists of two parts:

1. The central, early site from Middle Bronze Age I-II covers most of the ridge. It was surrounded by



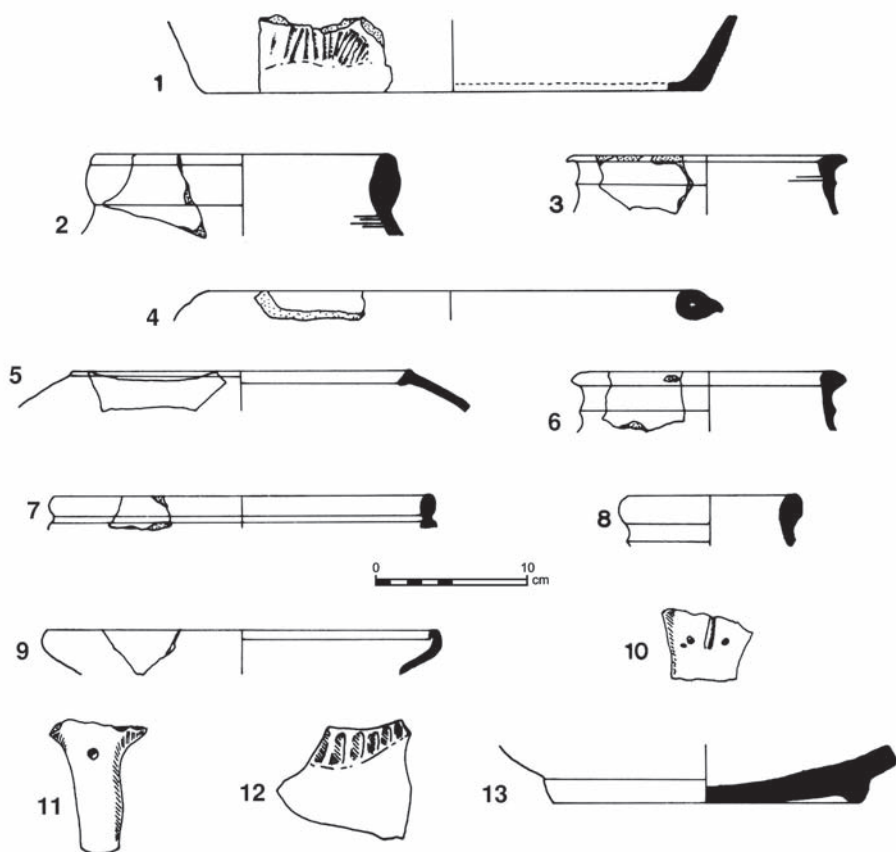
219. View of the el-Bird ridge, looking east. The ridge is surrounded by deep wadis. At the upper part is the fortified site with its casement wall. 1983.

an enclosure wall 50 cm wide, possibly for fortification. Many buildings were found scattered on the ridge, most of them square ones with openings and courtyards. In the lower, eastern side of the ridge the entrances of the houses have also survived. In the middle of the site a built road, or a street, was found. The houses' walls are one stone (30 cm) wide. In the whole area many shards from Middle Bronze Age I-

II were collected.

2. At the upper, western part of the site, are two large, square courtyards, each about 25x25 m. Openings, building stones and a fortified gateway on the south side were found in them. In this area, shards from the Iron Age and onwards were found.

It appears that this upper portion is a square casemate fortress from



220. Pottery from the multi period el-Bird site: nos. 1, 5, 12 – MBA I; 3-4, 6-7, 9 – MBA IIB; 2, 10-11, 13 – IrA I; 8 – IrA II: 1. HM Jar, gray; 2. Pythos, dk; 3. Folded CP, br; 4. Jar, pinkish; 5. HM jar, yel; 6. Jar, br; 7. Crater, yel; 8. Jar, br; 9. Bowl, lt; 10-11. Dec handles, br; 12. Rope dec, gray; 13. Crater base, br.

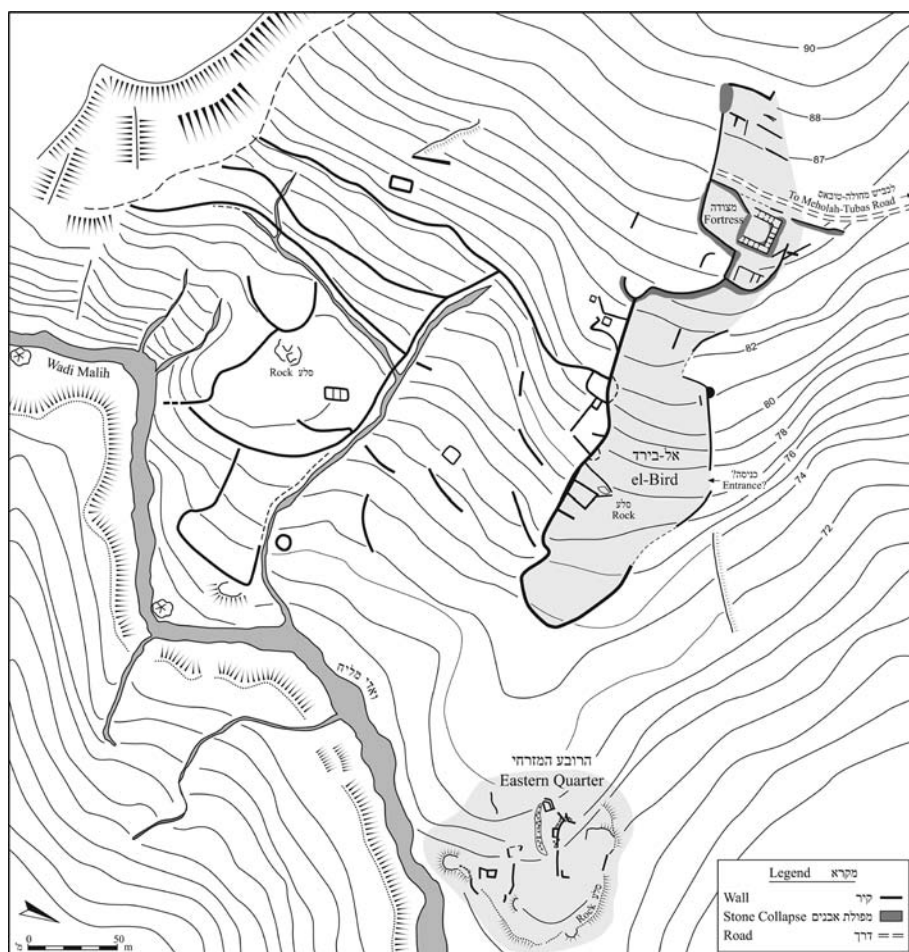
Iron Age II, but this identification requires further research.

Pottery: MBA I – 30%; MBA IIB – 30%; LB III – 5%; IrA IA – 5%;

“Eynun pottery” (IrA I) – 5%; IrA II – 20%; Per – 5%.

Flint find: Six undefined items.

Previous surveys: none.



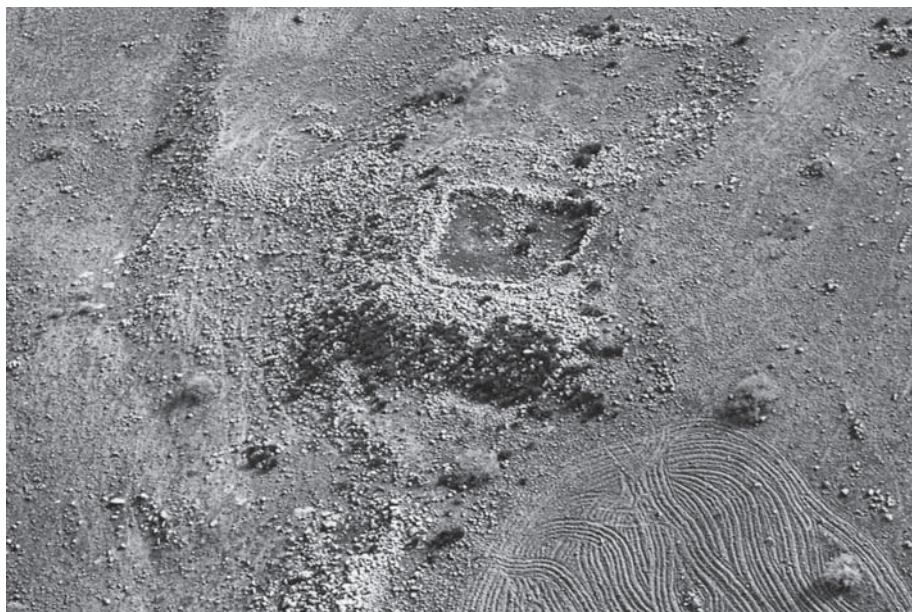
221. Plan of el-Bird and its surrounding. The site was connected to a large agricultural area to its south. Winter 2006.



222. Plan of the city of el-Bird. The site is surrounded by an enclosure wall. Winter 2006.



223 . Some of the well preserved structures of the Middle Bronze Age I settlement on the ridge of el-Bird. 1983.



224. Aerial photo of the casemate fortress and surrounding structures, on the upper part of el-Bird. The later courtyard in the center of the photo marks the boundaries of the fortress. Winter 1993.

Site 92: 19 – 19/52/1

Khirbet Malih (A), (SWP map: Kh. el-Maleh; Guérin: Kh. Tleilat el-Maleh, and in the modern map: Hamam el-Malih)

Israel grid: 1951 1928

UTM grid: 7337 5799

Elevation: 25 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 13 dunams (3.3 acres)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Malih, no. 87), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Jan. 27, 1983; Nov. 5, 1993; 35 shards

A complex of structures and ancient baths at the foot of a low hill in a valley, close to the gorge of Wadi

Malih.

On the western side of the site is a building with a row of rooms built



225. The *grotto* of Wadi and Hamam el-Malih, looking west. The hot springs are located near the palm trees; to their right were the baths. In the background is the hill of E.P. 174. Winter 1994.

of ashlars, and a plastered pool with a cistern east of it. On the northern bank of the wadi is a large structure dating to the Ottoman Period, used as a warm bath (Arab. *Hamam*). Behind and south of it are remains of other structures, while in front of it, northwards and in the part descending to the river, are a large courtyard and eucalyptus trees. 250 m to the east, near the river gorge, is a mill with an *aqueduct* leading to it. They also date to the Ottoman Period. Above the mill, on the mountain slope, is a ruined stone

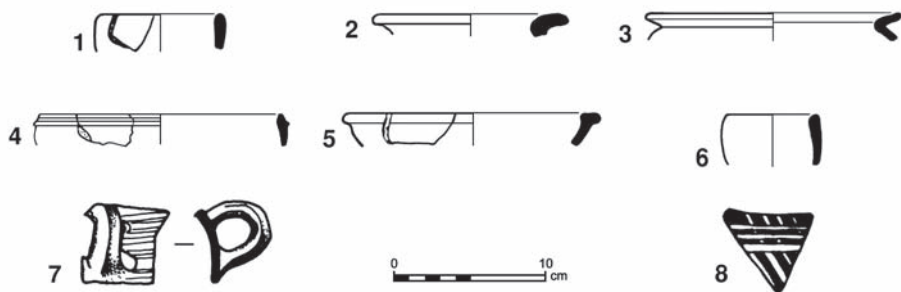
structure, probably used as a guard-house for the site. The site served as baths with hot water at least from the Roman Period onward.

Pottery: ER – 10%; Byz – 30%; EM – 20%; MA – 20%; Ott – 20%.

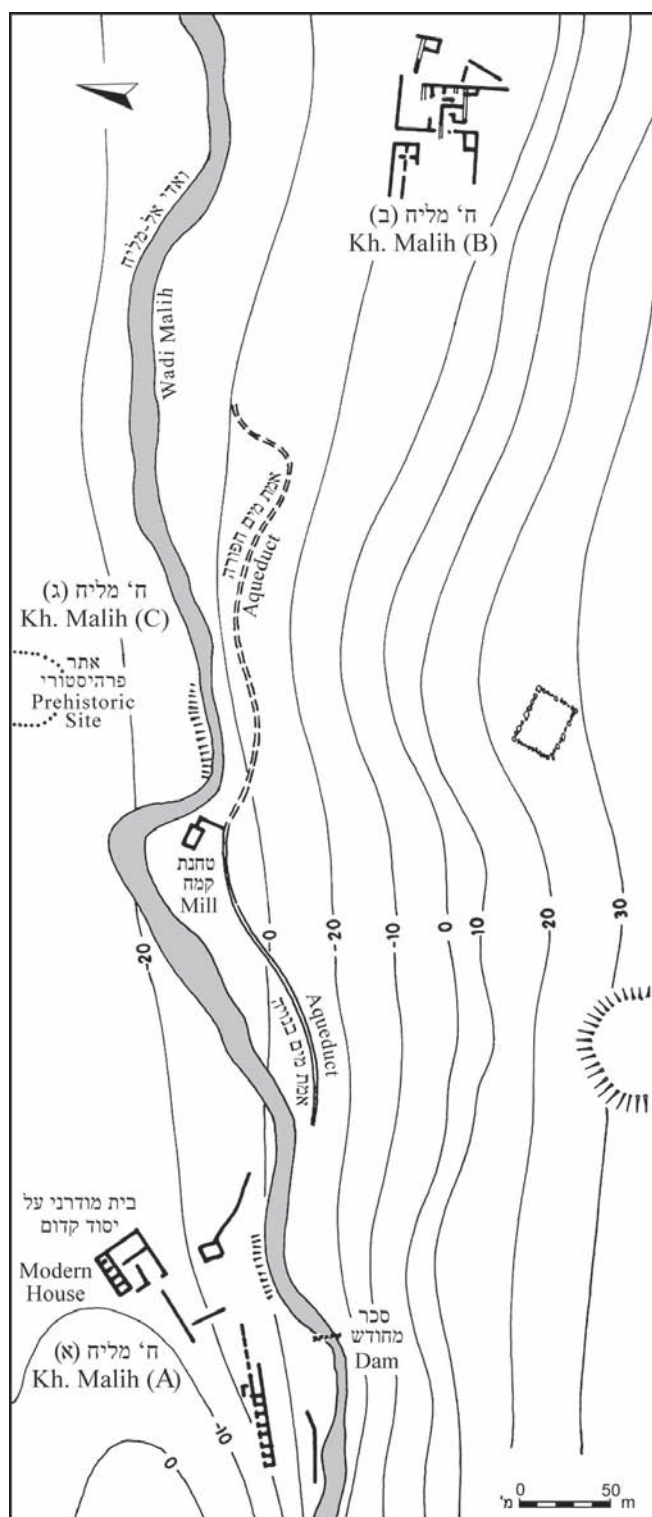
Guérin's suggestion that this site is *Abel Meholah* does not appear reasonable; see chapter three.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 84.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 275; SWP II, 239; Ozerman 1982.



226. Pottery from Hamam el-Malih: 1. Jug, lt br, ER; 2. Jar, lt, LR; 3. Bowl, lt, LR; 4. Bowl, dk, Byz; 5. Bowl, yel, EM; 6. Jug, br, Byz; 7. Jar handle, br, Byz; 8. Dec, wh on bl, Byz-EM.



227. The overall plan of the bath complexes in Hamam el-Malih. The plan shows the modern and ancient buildings of the site (Kh. Malih (A), below), the *aqueduct* and Ottoman Period flour mill (center), the tower (center right) and the prehistoric site (Kh. Malih (C), center left) and Kh. Malih (B) in the upper part.

Site 93: 19 – 19/52/2

Khirbet Malih (B)

Israel grid: 1959 1927

UTM grid: 7335 5799

Elevation: 25 m b.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: ravine at the valley edge of wadi

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa, Mediterranean

brown forest soil and Colluvial – Alluvial; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: river (Wadi Malih, no. 103), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.3 km distant

Visibility: 3

Feb. 29, 1988; 29 shards

* * *

Well built structures on a small, artificial hill in a valley south of Wadi Malih, about 0.5 km east of Hamam el-Malih (Kh. Malih (A)).

A large complex of structures,

built according to a very strict plan, are found here. The masonry is good, of medium sized, hewn stones. The complex is bordered on the north by an enclosure wall. The inner plan contains rooms and



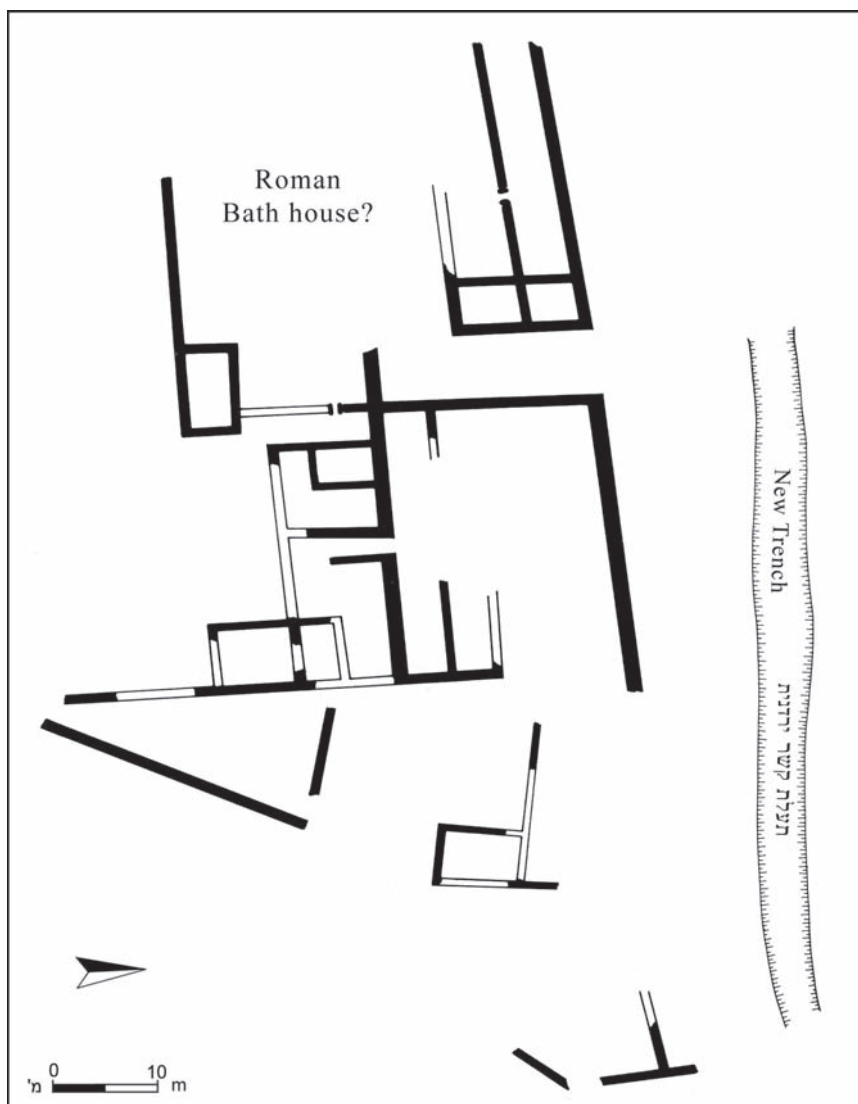
230. The site of Kh. Malih (B), looking north. The ruins are in the center of the valley, behind Wadi Malih. The road to the Jordan Valley runs through the distant part of the valley, while in the background are the ridges of Kh. Jabaris. Winter 1994.

possible streets or passageways. The western and southern parts of the place have been heavily damaged by bulldozers. In the northeast corner, hewn installations were found.

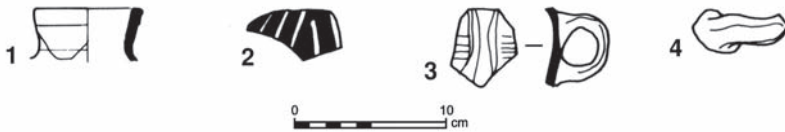
Pottery: LR – 40%; Byz – 50%; EM – 10%.

The site seems to be connected to the bath complexes of Hamam el-Malih. This was possibly an inn or commercial quarter for the visitors to the baths during the Roman-Byzantine Period.

Previous surveys: none.



229. Plan of Kh. Malih (B).



228. Pottery from Kh. Malih (B), Byz: 1. Jug, br; 2. Dec, wh on bl; 3. Jar handle, br; 4. 'Frying pan' handle, br.



Site 94: 19 – 19/53/1

Khirbet Malih (C)

Israel grid: 1957 1930

UTM grid: 7335 5800

Elevation: 30 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: prehistoric

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: hill in river valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: river (Wadi Malih, no. 103), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Nov. 5, 1993; 633 flint items

* * *

A small site on a hill in the valley of Wadi Malih and north of the wadi itself. The modern road from Tubas to Meholah passes near the site.

An especially large scatter of flint items and flint tools was found at the site, on the top and sides of the

hill. Scattered stones, possibly connected to structures, were found on the summit.

Flint find: Kebaran Geometrical; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 95: 19 – 19/62/1

Abu Qandul

Israel grid: 1961 1926

UTM grid: 7339 5795

Elevation: 10 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 6 dunams (1.5 acres)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: 'Arad formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 4

Nearest water source: river (Wadi Malih, no. 103), 0.2 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.6 km distant

Visibility: 4

Jan. 27, 1983; Apr. 1, 1992; 78 shards

* * *

A large architectural complex of a farm on the slope of Abu Qandul, which descends northeastward to the valley of Wadi Malih, about 1 km east southeast of Hamam el-Malih.

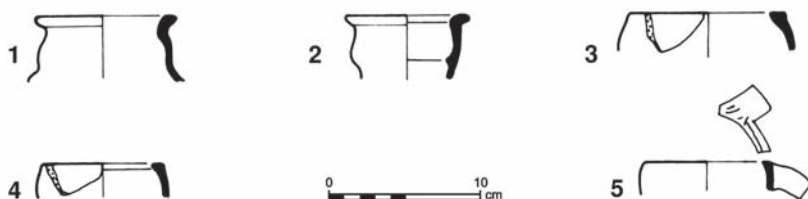
The site includes a square, central courtyard, about 50x50 m in size, surrounded by a wall of large stones. Along the southern and western walls of the yard are series of rooms, and different walls penetrate into the inner space of the

courtyard. Other enclosures extend from it to the south and north, with no structures inside.

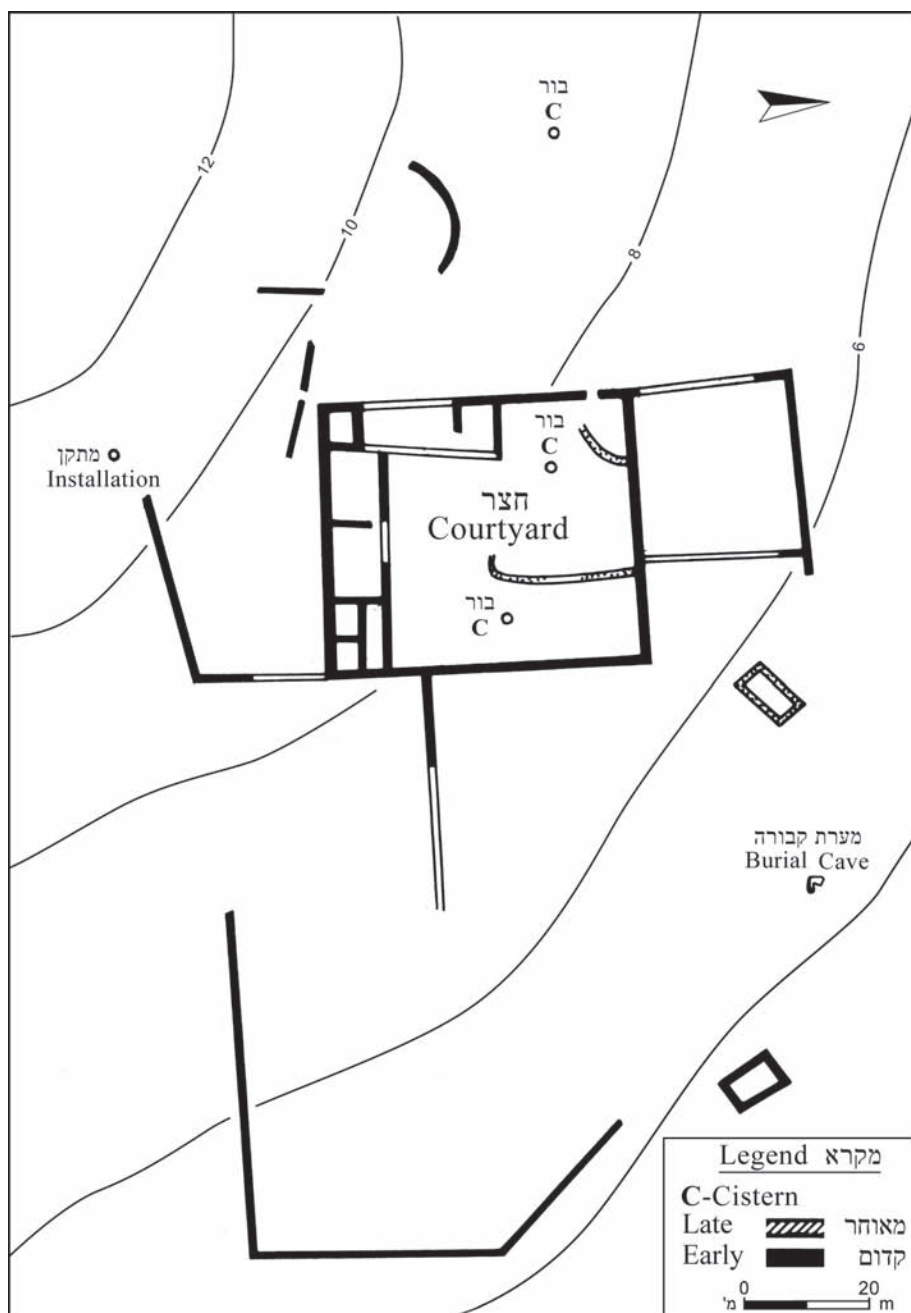
About 0.1 km east of the courtyard there is another enclosure based upon terrace walls, and next to them other small structure are located. Near and inside the site's area are cisterns, a burial cave and installations, as well as a modern structure.

Pottery: Byz – 95%; MA – 5%.

Previous surveys: none.



231. Pottery from the Abu Qandul farm, all Byz: 1. Jar, dk; 2. Jug, dk; 3-5. Jars, br.



232. Plan of the Abu Qandul farm. The farm structures are inside the square courtyard, with various structures around it.

Site 96: 19 – 19/72/1

Tel el-Hilu (on SWP map: Tel Sheikh Sifry)

Israel grid: 1978 1926

UTM grid: 7356 5798

Elevation: 20 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical place on map

Site type: small tell

Area: 3.2 dunams (0.8 acre)

Topography: river valley surrounded by mountain ranges

Rock type: 'Arad formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and desert – alluvium; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), next to site

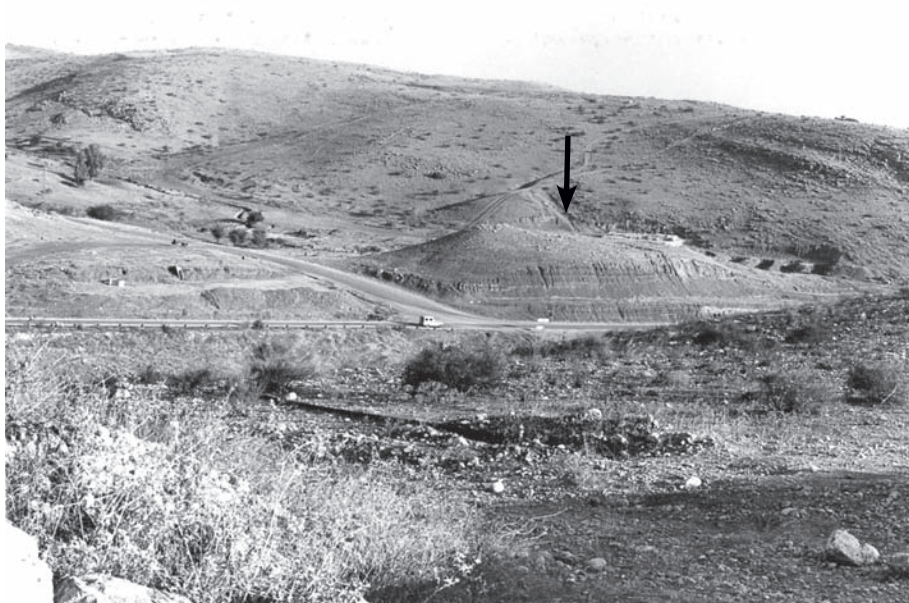
Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8) and Beqa'ot – Meholah (C23), both passe by site

Visibility: 3

Feb. 10, 1983, Jan. 11, 1991, 108 shards

A tell in a small valley, near the place where Wadi Malih turns north and enters its canyon. North of the tell are springs ('Uyun Hilu), and an important crossroads.

The eastern side of the tell is “cut” by the Taiyasir – Meholah road. In this cross section floors, living layers, graves and walls are discernible. On the top of the tell are the

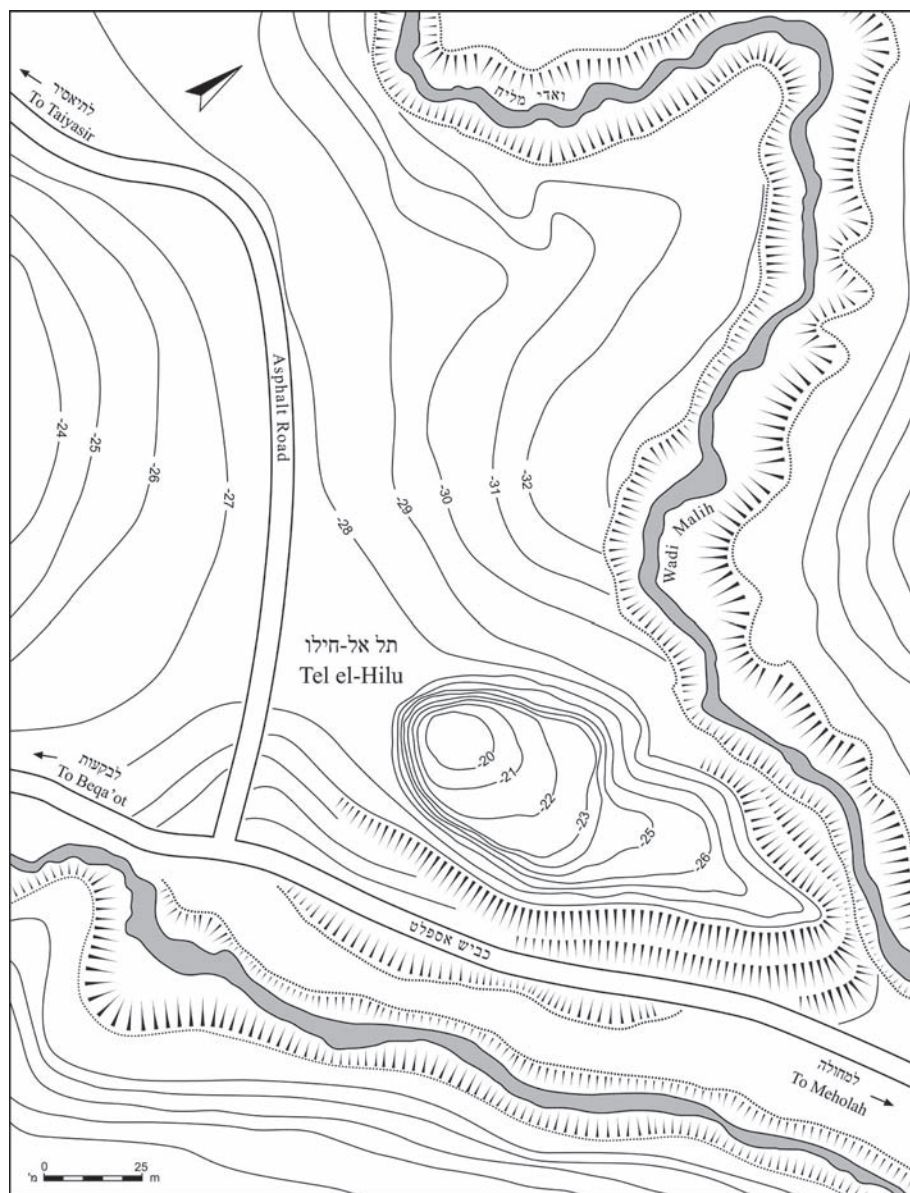


233. Tel el-Hilu and its valley, looking north. The Tel is in the center, and Wadi Malih is seen to its left.

remnants of four structures *in situ* with only one course of stones. On and around the tell is an abundant shard scatter, including many painted shards.

Pottery: EBA II – 5%; MBA IIB – 5%; LBA I – 5%; LBA II – 5%; LBA III – 50%; IrA IB-C – 10%; IrA II – 10%; Per – 10%.

The tell was identified by Glueck

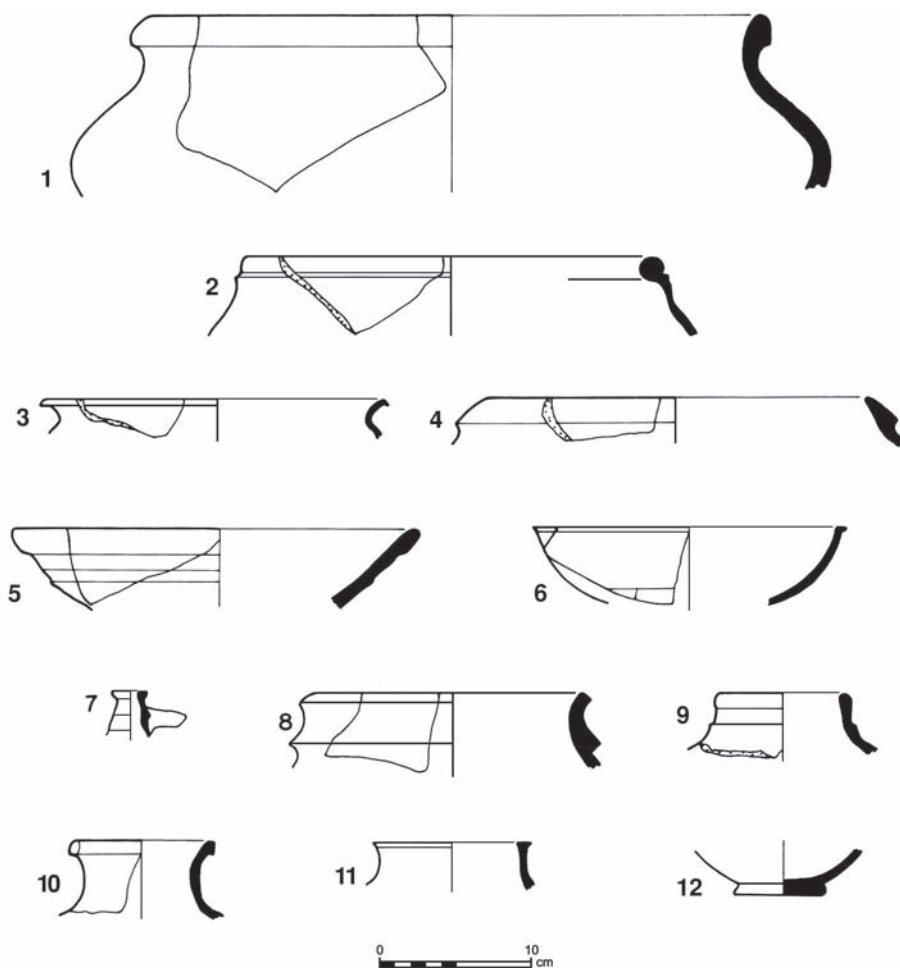


234. Plan of Tel el-Hilu and its position. The site is defended by the two deep wadis. Winter 2006.

as *Yogme'am* (I Kings 4:12) and by Albright, Alt and Abel as *Abel Meholah* (Judges 7:22; I Kings 4:12; 19:16). Both identifications are problematic; see discussion in chapter three.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 86.

Bibliography: SWP II, 218; Albright 1925; Alt 1928; Abel 1967a, 80, 96; Glueck 1943, 9 ff.; Zobel 1966.



235. Pottery from Tel el-Hilu: 1. Crater/CP, dk, LB-IrA I; 2. CP, dk, IrA II; 3. CP, br, IrA IA; 4. CP, br, IrA IB; 5. Bowl, yel, Per; 6. Bowl, yel, LB; 7. Jug, br, IrA I-II; 8. Ridged jar, dk, IrA II; 9-10. Jars, br, IrA II; 11. Jar, lt br, IrA II; 12. Bowl base, lt, MBA II.



236. Pottery photos from Tell el-Hilu: 1. Crater/CP, LB; 2. 'Mortaria' bowl, Per; 3, 5. Jugs, IrA II; 4. Base of small bowl, LB.

CHAPTER EIGHT

RAS JADIR

LANDSCAPE UNIT 16



A stone circle typical to the central hill country

From: *The SWP*, vol. II, p. 305

(Drawing by G. Stanford)

Site 97: 18 – 19/72/2

el-Hozah

Israel grid: 1879 1925

UTM grid: 7260 5793

Elevation: 540 m a.s.l. 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 8 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 9

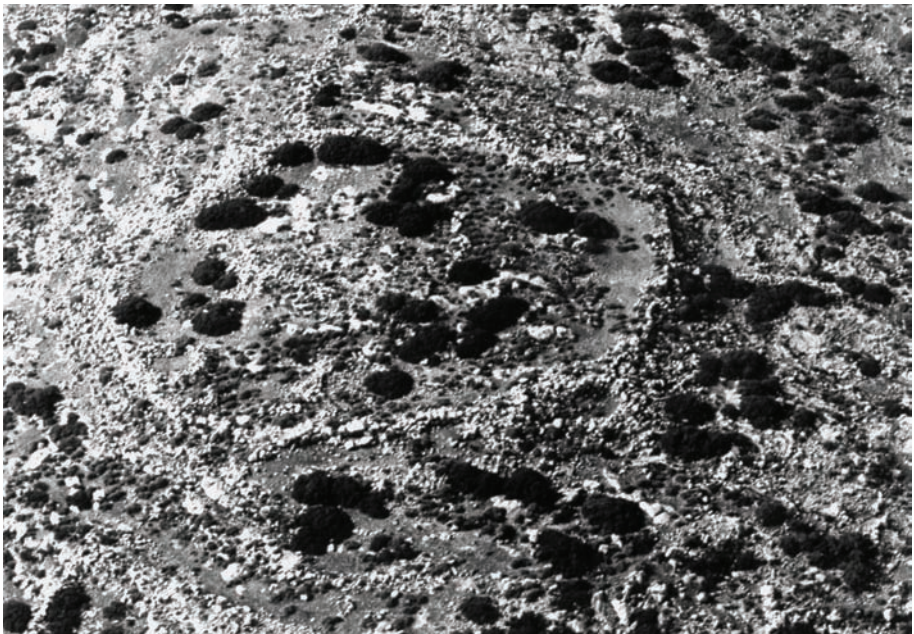
Apr. 21, 1981; 3 shards

* * *

An enclosure on a high and isolated summit, in the northern part of Ras Jadir and 2.5 km east of Tubas.

The site is an irregular shaped, stone built enclosure 30x20 m in diameter, located on the summit. The enclosure wall is of one course (1 m wide) of large, unhewn stones.

Attached to the wall from the outside and north is a small stone structure, presumably later than the enclosure. Two circles of small stones are inside the enclosure, otherwise empty of structures. Related to the enclosure is a wall which goes south over the ridge, for about 0.1

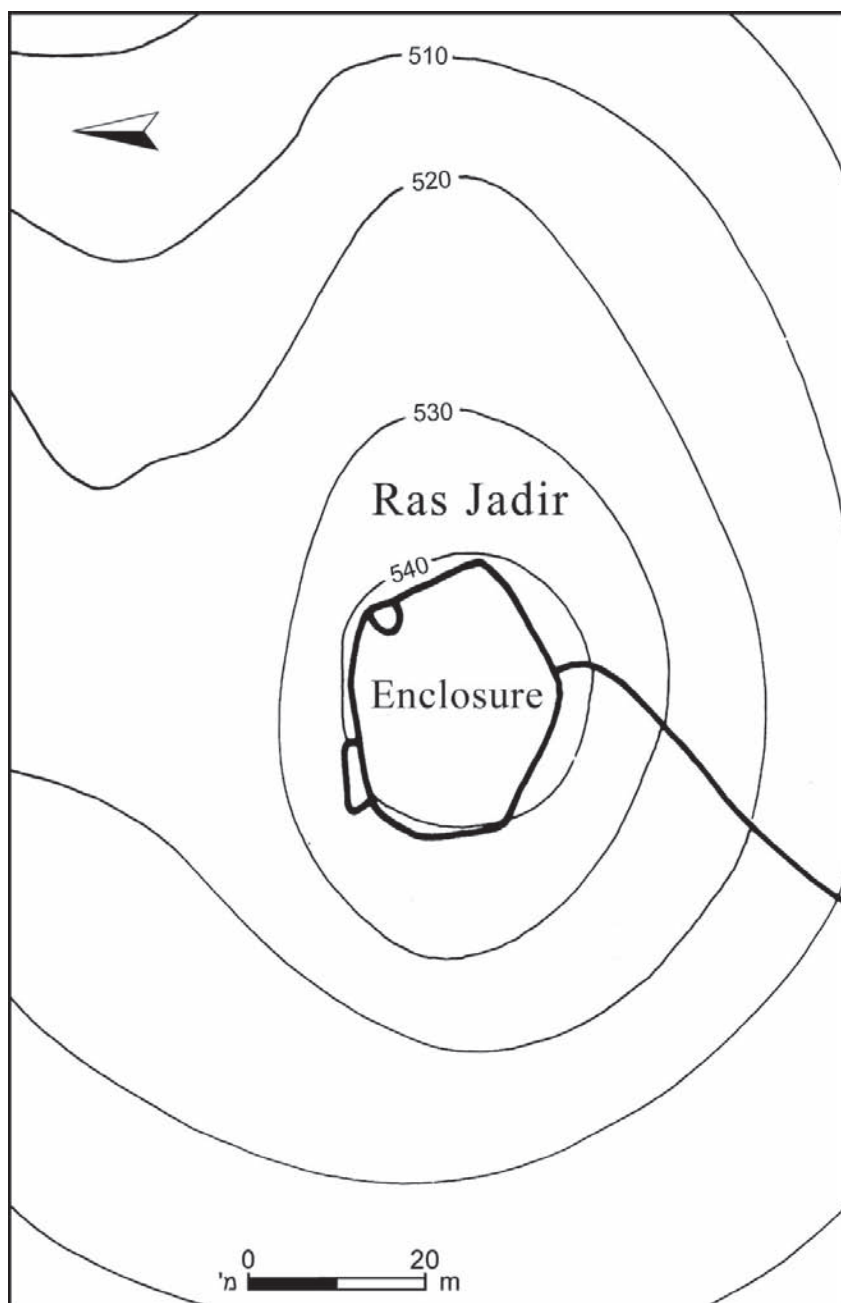


236. The stone built enclosure at el-Hoza, looking south. 1993.

km. There are almost no shards inside, and only three fragments were detected. Thus dating is uncertain.

Pottery: MBA IIB – (one shard!)

Previous surveys: none.



237. Plan of the enclosure of el-Hozah.

Site 98: 18 – 19/72/3

et-Tughrah

Israel grid: 1873 1921

UTM grid: 7254 5789

Elevation: 505 m a.s.l., 140
m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and

terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah
(B8), 1 km distant

Visibility: 8

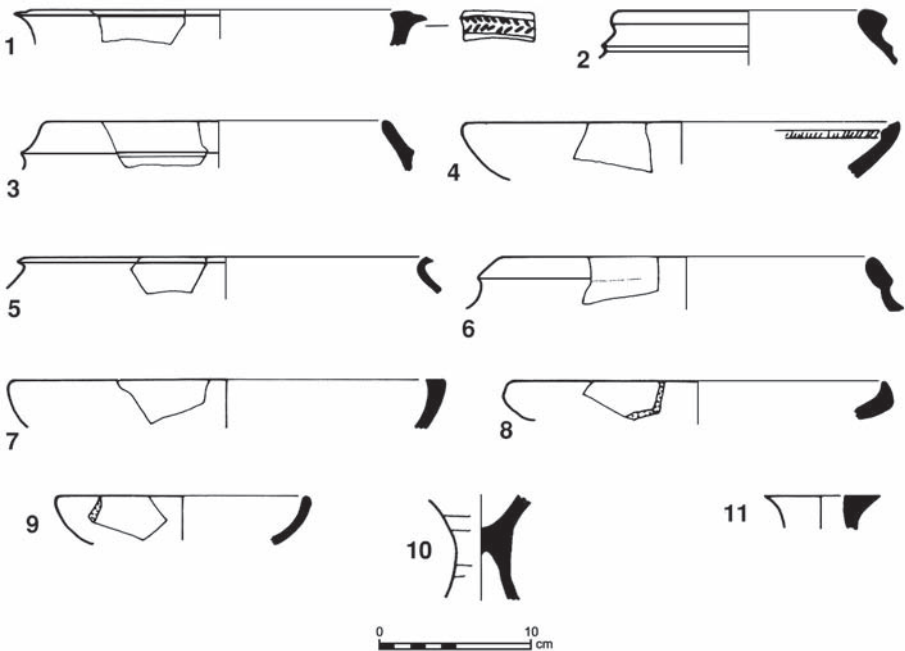
May 3, 1981; 46 shards

* * *

A small site on a slope of an elongated ridge, in the western part of Ras Jadir and 2 km east of Tubas.

The site is surrounded, in the

west and south, by a simple wall of unhewn stones; it may have been used as a fortification. Inside are several walls and structures whose



238. Pottery from et-Tughrah, nos. 1, 4, 10-11 – MBA II; 3, 5, 7-9 – IrA IA; the rest – IrA II: 1. Crater, yel, fishbone dec; 2. Ridged/Carinated jar, br; 3. CP, br; 4. Bowl, yel, dec inside; 5. CP, dk br; 6. Crater, br; 7-9. Bowls, lt br; 10. Chalice, yel; 11. Jug, br.

plans are blurred by piles of cleared stones. The most complete of these, in the south of the site, is built of very large, hewn stones; possibly, it was once part of a larger, central structure.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 20%; IrA IA – 60%; IrA II – 20%.

Special find: Crater's rim with embossed fishbone decoration.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 99: 19 – 19/11/1

Qta'at el-Khalifeh

Israel grid: 1912 1913

UTM grid: 7290 5782

Elevation: 210 m a.s.l., 20 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: shard scatter

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: ridge and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Meholah (B8), 2 km distant

Visibility: 1

Feb. 6, 1987; 31 shards and 2 flint items



239. General view of Qta'at el-Khalifeh, looking east. The shard scatter was found in the center of the ravine. In background: the ridges of Ras Jadir, descending eastward. Winter 1987.

A site in a small ravine, in the ridges east of Ras Jadir and about 0.7 km north of Kh. Yarzah (site 104). Next to it is a well named Bir Abu Tayib.

Concentrations of shards and flint items, including adzes, were

found on the site, with no building remains.

Pottery and flint: Ghassulian Chal – 100%; for flint find see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 100: 19 – 19/41/2

Khirbet Umm el-‘Uqbeh (B)

(on 50.000 map - Kh. Umm el-Qibeh)

Israel grid: 1941 1911

UTM grid: 7319 5783

Elevation: 80 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: farm and structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge and step

Rock type: alluvium cover

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

Jan 21, 1987; Apr. 22, 1993; 28 shards

A large structure on a low step in the northern edge of Hawakir Valley, between Burj el-Malih and Kh. es-Samrah.

The structure, built in “n” shape with unequal wings, is 27x23 m in overall size. The eastern wing is 27 m long, while the western one is only 16 m long. Each wing is 8 m wide; the eastern one contains three rooms, and the western one has two. In the center of the structure is a small, inner courtyard. Part of the western wing may have been dismantled.

The walls are of small stones with bonding material. The amount of

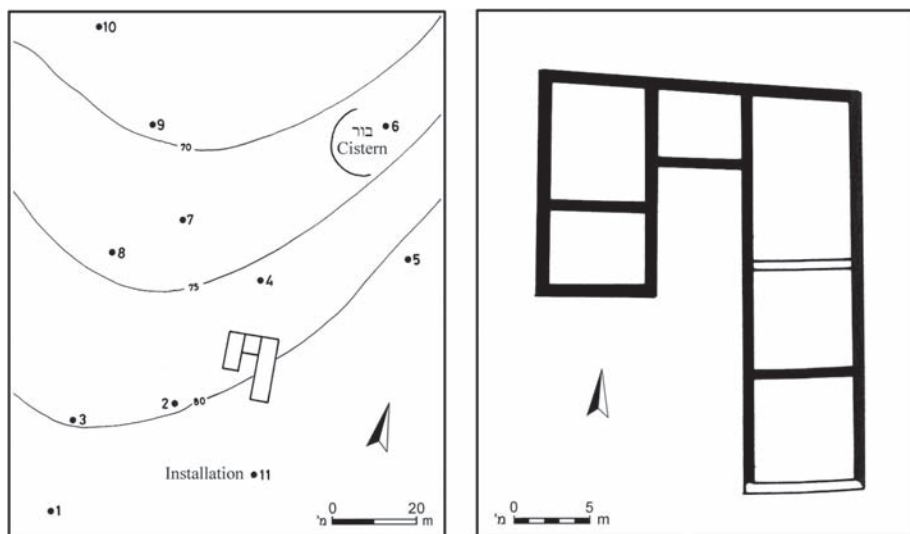
fallen stones hints for the existence of a second storey. About 50 m northeast of the structure is an active cistern, with a grinding stone in secondary use as a cover.

At least ten complexes of hewn installations, dating prior to Iron Age, were found 20-75 m distant from the structure.

The structure, which may have been built after 1870 CE, does not appear on the SWP map. In the immediate vicinity are several structures of this type.

Pottery: Ott – 50%; Mod – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.



240. At right – plan of the structure at Kh. Umm el-‘Uqbeh (B). At left – plan of the hill, containing hewn installations (numbered here).



Site 101: 19 – 19/61/1

Khallet Mahmud el-‘Ali (A)

Israel grid: 1968 1918

UTM grid: 7348 5789

Elevation: 35 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.2 dunam (0.05 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown for-

est soil; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs (‘Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 0.8 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa‘ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Jan. 23, 1987; 7 shards

A structure in a small ravine on a slope descending into Wadi el-Fau, near the junction of the Tubas – Meholah road and with the Beqa‘ot road, about 1 km southwest of Tel el-Hilu.

There is here a solitary structure

built of large, unhewn field stones. It contains a long hall, 2.5x10 m in size, in the corner of which is a semicircular structure. Shards from the Middle Bronze Age were found scattered over the eastern slope.

This was a house or a farm, pre-

sumably related with nearby Tel el-Hilu.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 102: 19 – 19/61/2

Khallet Mahmud el-‘Ali (B)

Israel grid: 1969 1918

UTM grid: 7350 5787

Elevation: 45 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 4.8 dunams (1.2 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs (‘Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 0.8 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa‘ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

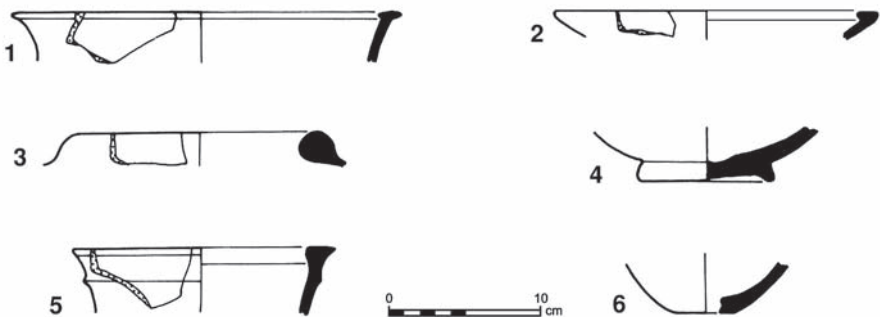
Visibility: 2

Jan. 23, 1987; 42 shards

A site on a slope descending into Khallet Mahmud el-‘Ali, close to the road from Tel el-Hilu to Beqa‘ot (C23) and 5 km south southeast of Meholah.

The buildings stand on a low, natural slope. They consists of a 45 m long strip of three, well built architectural units, located between

the cliff and the slope and stand upon terraces. The western unit has two rooms and a yard (?); the central one consists of two small (3X4 m) rooms; and the eastern unit has three rooms and a half round yard. Other buildings may have belonged to the site, but only scattered walls remained of them. Above the cliff



241. Pottery from the site, all MBA IIB: 1. Crater, yel; 2. Bowl, lt; 3. Folded CP, dk br; 4. Bowl, yel; 5. Jar, pinkish; 6. Jug, lt.

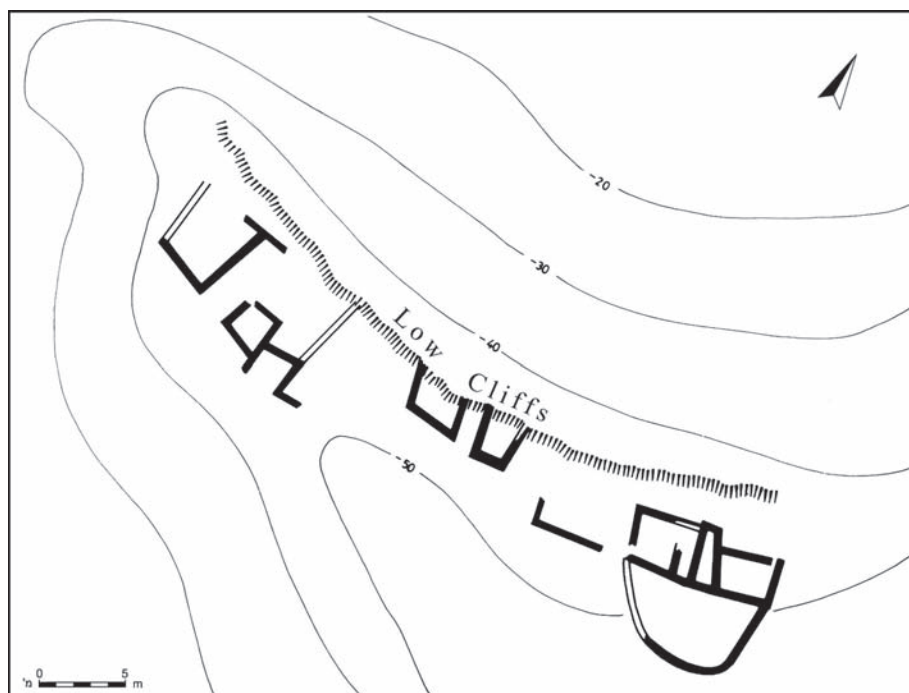
there are remains of three more structures.

This well built settlement from Middle Bronze Age II, at the fringes of the desert, is part of a group of sites located south of it. Their pot-

tery seems to differ from the Mediterranean region; see introduction on ceramics.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



242. Plan of the Khallet Mahmud el-'Ali (B) site, with the strip of structures along the slope.



243. A view of the Middle Bronze Age II village at Khamat Mahmud el-'Ali (B), looking north. The structures are on the upper part of the slope, below the bushes seen on the horizon. Winter 1992.



Site 103: 18 – 19/90/1

Ras Jadir

Israel grid: 1891 1908
 UTM grid: 7270 5774
 Elevation: 712 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: shard scatter
 Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)
 Topography: hilltop on plateau
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 5

Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: springs ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 7 km distant
 Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 3 km distant
 Visibility: 8
 Apr. 21, 1981; 39 shards

* * *

A shard scatter on a small hilltop, on the southern part of upper Ras Jadir.

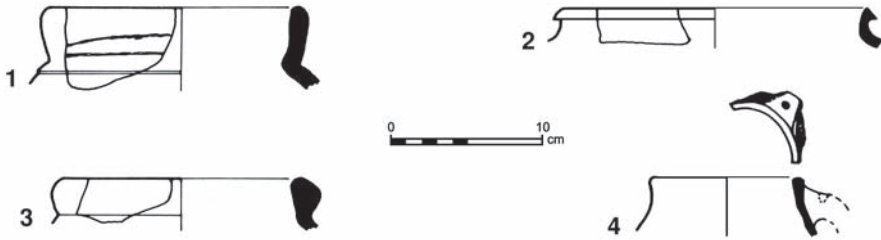
The site is in a rocky, stony area.

No structural remains were found, but apparently one or two structures once stood there. Over an area of several hundreds square meters,

among the rocks, was a single period shard scatter.

Pottery: IrA IA – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



244. Pottery from Ras Jadir, all from IrA IA: 1, 3. Pythoi, br; 2. CP, dk br; 4. Jug with indented dec, lt br.



Site 104: 19 – 19/10/2

Khirbet Yarzah (B) (on SWP map: Kh. Yerzeh)

Israel grid: 1913 1905

UTM grid: 7295 5776

Elevation: 278 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin (a town)

Area: 60 dunams (15 acres)

Topography: ridge edge, hilltop and ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 40

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 2 km distant

Visibility: 3

Apr. 15-23, 1982; May 21, 1993; 82 shards

A large ruin in a hilly area, east of Ras Jadir and south of the Taiyasir – Meholah road. In the area, some 6 km east of Tubas, there is a complex of sites.

On a low, broad mountain range the remains of 70 or more structures *in situ*, built of hewn stones and 1 m high in average, were found. In the buildings' entrances

there are preserved doorposts and architraves, with different installations. On a summit north of the site (E.P. 278) is a large structure *in situ*, probably a church. It includes five pillars, 50 cm in diameter, and many carved architectural items. On the western slope are a number of burial caves. One of these (a *mausoleum*) is well built with ash-

lars on its façade, hewn steps and a central hall. Inside there are three arches and burial niches. Another structure, presumably a mosque, with a terebinth tree inside is in the vicinity. A well built, 4 m wide Roman road reaches the site from the north.

Today, several Bedouin families live among the ruins. In their animal pens building stones from the site are interwoven and re used.

This is an important small town in the area from the Byzantine Period.

Pottery: LR – 10%; Byz – 90%.

Guérin, who visited here on May 4, 1870, noted the large size of the site, the mosque, the burial caves and the two terebinth trees. Conder and Kitchener (April 2nd, 1874) mention the Roman road leading to the site, the villa, the church, and the burials.

Identification: *Asher* of the Byzantine Period (Onomasticon, p. 27); see chapter three.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 360-361; SWP II, 242.



245. Aerial photo of Kh. Yarzah, looking north. In the center of the ridge are many structures of the Roman–Byzantine Period site, with modern structures and Bedouin fences among them. To the left the ancient tell is seen. In the ravine behind it is the road to Ras Mrah el-Wawiyat. Winter 1993.

Site 105: 19 – 19/20/1

Ras Mrah el-Wawiyat

Israel grid: 1921 1902

UTM grid: 7303 5771

Elevation: 275 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map but not as historical site

Site type: shard scatter

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 2.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

May 21, 1993; 41 shards

* * *

A site on a wide hilltop in the hills east of Ras Jadir, about 0.5 km southeast of Kh. Yarzah (B). From the site is a fine view of the territory surrounding the Yarzah sites.

An extensive shard scatter, especially body shards, is spread on the southern part of the hilltop. Slo-

pily built walls of large stones – terraces or fences – were also found. These seems to date to a later period than that of the shards.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 22%; IrA IA – 58%; IrA II – 17%; Others – 3%.

Previous surveys: none.



246. The hill of Ras Mrah el-Wawiyat, looking southeast. The site is at the top of the hill, near the tree. Spring 1993.

Site 106: 19 – 19/10/1

Khirbet Yarzah (A) (on SWP map: Kh. Yerzeh)

Israel grid: 1913 1904

UTM grid: 7294 5775

Elevation: 270 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: tell

Area: 11 dunams (2.75 acres)

Topography: ridge edge, hilltop and ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 5

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 2 km distant

Visibility: 5

Apr. 15-23, 1982; Feb. 7, 1986; 112 shards

A tell in the low hills east of the Ras Jadir, about 2 km south of the Tubas – Meholah road and 5 km southeast of Taiyasir.

It is located on an elongated ridge with two hilltops, isolated from its environs by ravines. The ancient

tell is on the eastern of the two hilltops. There are no structural remains, but a rich and varied shard scatter. North of the tell are one or two structures, apparently from the Byzantine Period, quarries and caves.



247. The valley of Kh. Yarzah, looking south. The ridge of the site is at right; in the background (left), on the hilltop with the tree, is Mrah el-Wawiyat. Spring 1993.

Pottery: MBA I – 2%; MBA IIB – 5%; IrA IA – 20%; IrA II – 20%; IrA III – 10%; Per – 20%; Hel – 10%; ER – 3%; “Eynun” pottery (IrA I) – 10%.

Special find: Bowls with wedge decoration; rosette imprints; “Eynun faces”; handles with indented

decoration.

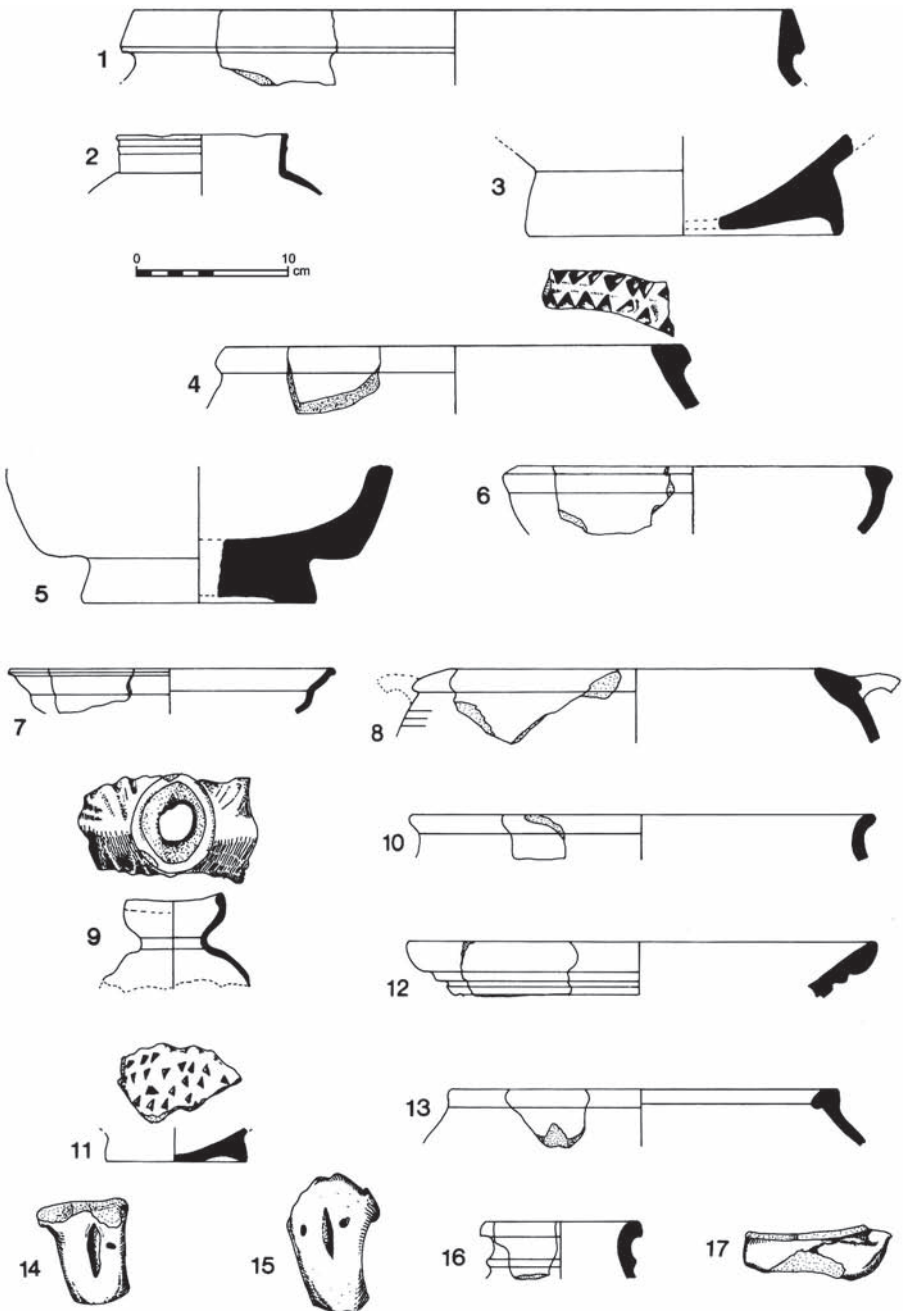
Identification: presumably with *Asher* (Joshua 17:7); see chapter three.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: Zertal 1990, 94 (regarding identification).



248. Photos of finds from Kh. Yarzah (A): 1-3. Indented handles, IrA I; 4. CP, IrA II; 5-6. Bowls, ER; 7. Crater, Age I; 8-10. misc.



249. Pottery from Kh. Yarzah (A): nos. 13, 17 – MBA I; 4, 7 – MBA II; 1, 3, 5, 10, 14-15 – IrA I; 6, 8, 16 – IrA II-III; 12 – Per; 2, 9 – Roman: 1. CP, dk; 2. Jar, br; 3. Crater base, dk; 4. Bowl with fishbone dec, yel; 5. Crater base, br; 6. Bowl, red slip; 7. Bowl, lt; 8. Crater, dk; 9. Jug, br; 10. Bowl/CP, dk; 11. Bowl, wedge dec, IrA III; 12. Bowl, yel; 13. Jar, Br; 14-15. Handles with indented dec; 16. Jar, br; 17. Folded ledge handle.

Site 107: 19 – 19/50/1

E.P. 147 (A)

Israel grid: 1956 1908

UTM grid: 7332 5781

Elevation: 147 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and shard scatter

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Malih, no. 87), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 7

Jan. 23, 1987; 17 shards

* * *

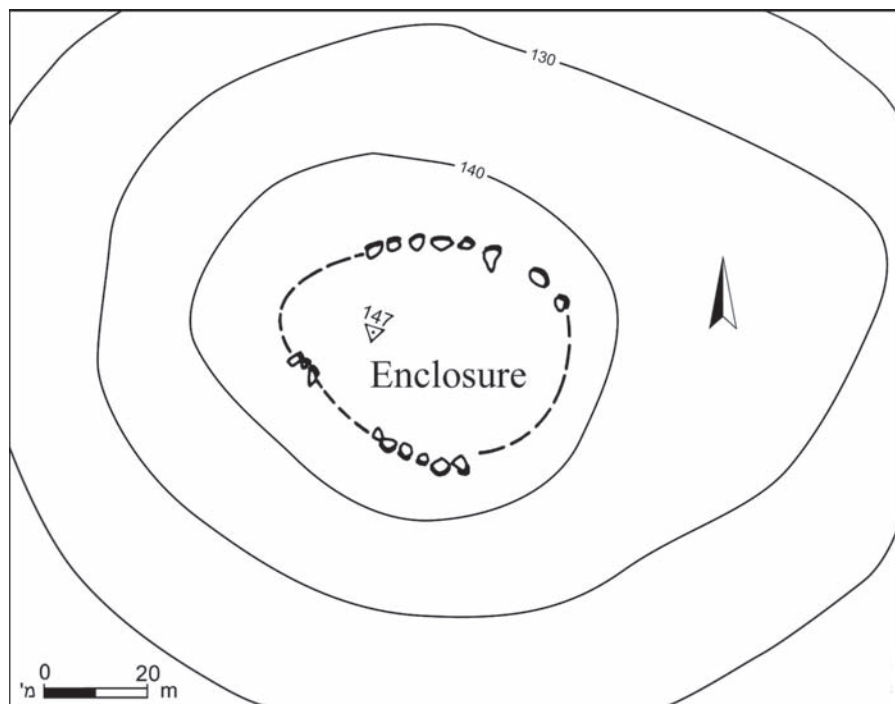
Remains of an enclosure on a high summit, in the hills west of the Beqa'ot – Meholah road and 5 km east of the Yarzah sites.

Only sections of the enclosure walls, built of large stones, have

survived. On the area is a medium sized shard scatter.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 80%; IrA II – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



250. Plan of the Middle Bronze Age II enclosure at E.P. 147 (A).

Site 108: 19 – 19/51/1

E.P. 147 (B)

Israel grid: 1959 1911

UTM grid: 7339 5782

Elevation: 80 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: mountainous rendzina;

quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Malih, no. 87), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1.8 km distant

Visibility: 6

Jan. 23, 1987; 19 shards

* * *

A farm complex on the eastern slope of E.P. 147, descending to the Beqa'ot – Meholah road.

A structure 6x8 m in size, built of large, hewn stones, is the nucleus of the place. Its masonry is precise, but without mortar. From this a wall, apparently the remains of a

courtyard, goes eastward and turns south. About 20 m to the south is a hewn cistern, with a covering stone and an opening for pumping water. A stone trough is located nearby.

Pottery: LR – 20%; Byz – 80%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 109: 18 – 19/90/1

Khallet en-Nakhleh

Israel grid: 1899 1901

UTM grid: 7281 5768

Elevation: 600 m a.s.l., 200 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: ridge edge and high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and terra rossa;

quality: 1

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 8 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Buqei'ah (C19), 1 km distant

Visibility: 10

Apr. 21, 1981; 60 shards

* * *

A small site on a very narrow, rocky «backbone» of Ras Jadir, located on its high, southeast summit. From

the site is a wide panorama of the hills east of Ras Jadir, the Buqei'ah and Jebel Tammun.

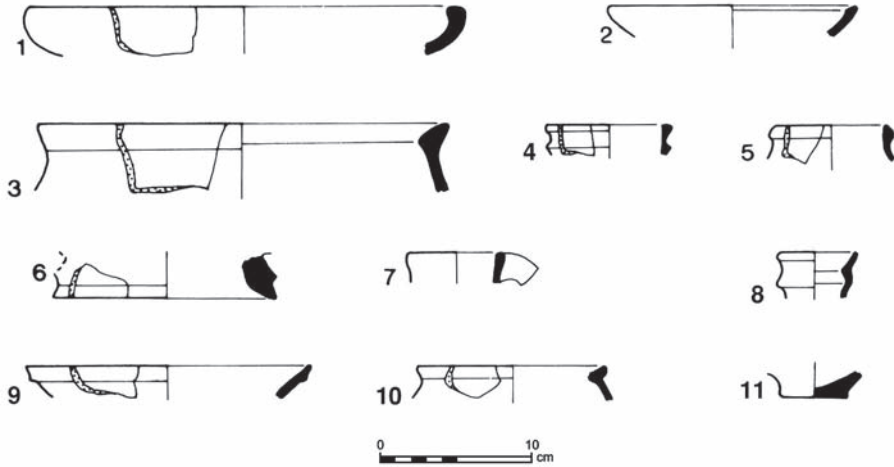
The only structural remains preserved is a wall of large, unhewn stones. Other sections of walls are discernible as well. A large shard scatter, especially in the northern part of the site, was found.

The unusual location and the ab-

sence of architecture suggest a security or cultic function.

Pottery: IrA IA – 100%. The identifiable shards are from this period, with others difficult to identify.

Previous surveys: none.



251. Pottery from Khallet en-Nakhleh, all from IrA IA: 1-2. Bowls, lt br; 3. Crater, br; 4-5. Jars, br; 6. Chalice base, br; 7-8. Jugs, lt br; 9. Bowl, yel; 10. Crater, br; 11. Jug base, lt br.



Site 110: 19 – 18/19/1

Wadi Khallet Abu 'Ali

Israel grid: 1918 1895

UTM grid: 7292 5762

Elevation: 280 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: built courtyard

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 3.5 km distant

Visibility: 1

Apr. 15, 1982; May 21, 1993; 8 shards

A courtyard on a slope of a low ravine, 1 km south – southeast of Kh. Yarzah (A-B).

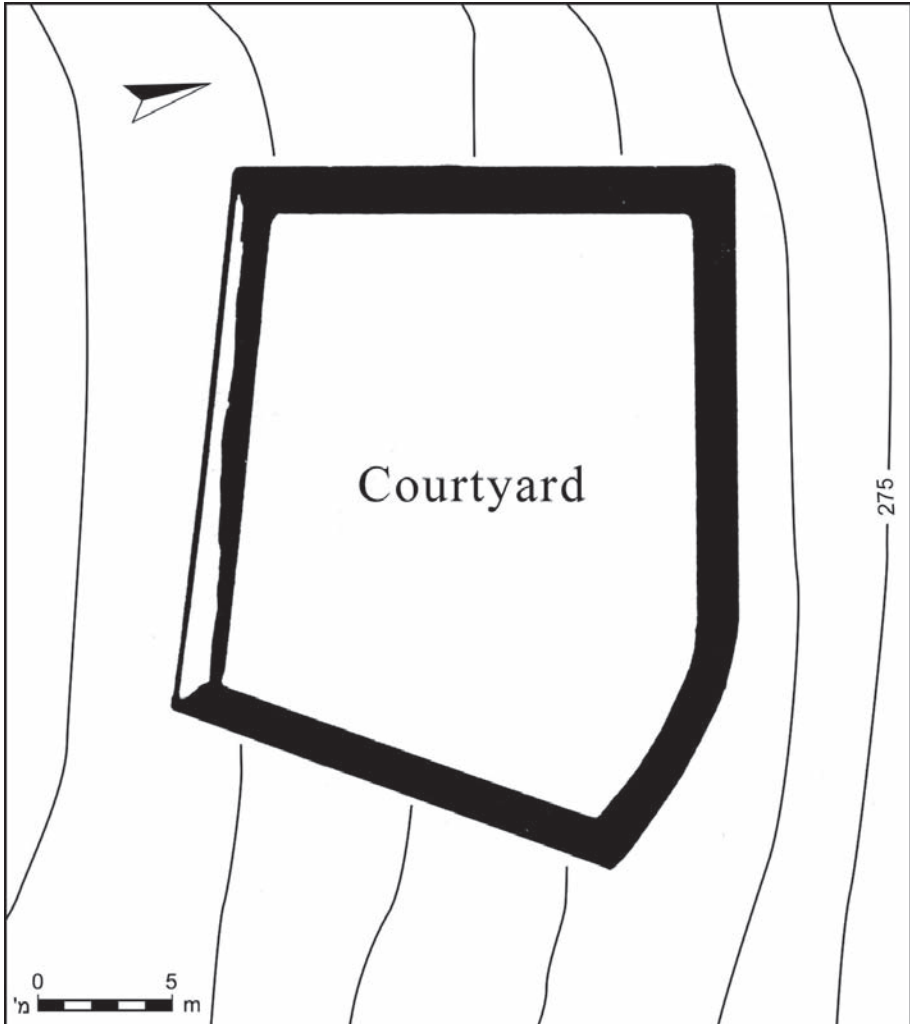
The trapezoid courtyard is 16x18 m in size, with a surrounding wall of large stones about 1 m wide. Few shards are scattered around the

courtyard.

This courtyard, similar to others in the area, was most probably used as an animal pen.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



252. The courtyard plan of Khallet Abu 'Ali.



253. The courtyard of Khallet Abu 'Ali, looking south. Most of these yards, apparently used for cattle, are situated on slopes.



Site 111: 19 – 18/38/2

Khallet esh-Shardeh

Israel grid: 1939 1889

UTM grid: 7319 5783

Elevation: 165 m a.s.l., 35 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosures and concentration of installations

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: low hilltop

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 2.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

May 21, 1993; 101 shards

A site on a low, wide hilltop in the hills north of the Buqe'ah, 1.5 km northwest of Kh. Yusef. The site

is located near Wadi Khallet esh-Shardeh and is surrounded by high hills. To its west the dirt road from

el-Hawakir to Ras Mubarah passes.

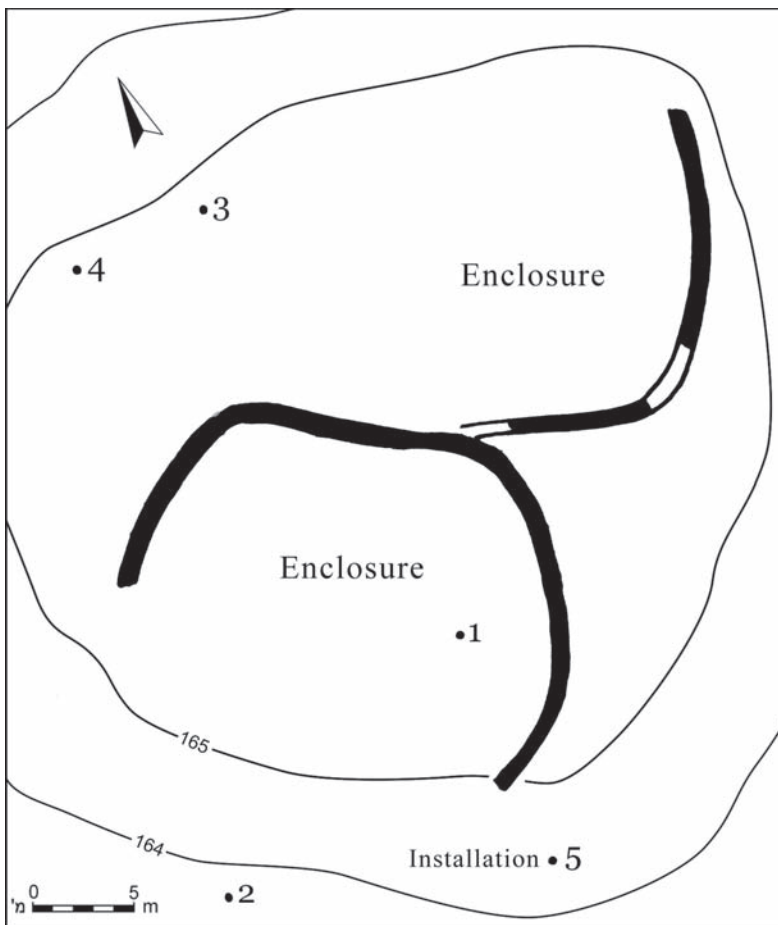
On the western part of the hill-top there are two enclosures next to each other. They are built of one row of large stones, some of them standing upright. The western enclosure is about 25 m in diameter; its inside had been cleaned of dirt, possibly for use as a threshing floor. From the second enclosure only one third has been preserved. At least five complexes of hewn instal-

lations of various types are scattered over the area. A good many shards are scattered around the installations.

Pottery: IrA I-II – 40% (only body shards); Byz – 40%; Mod – 20%.

The site was presumably an encampment of nomads during various periods, including the modern one.

Previous surveys: none.



254. Plan of the enclosures at Khallet esh-Shardeh. The figures on the plan indicate numbers of installations complexes.

Site 112: 19 – 18/49/2

el-Hawakir (B)

Israel grid: 1945 1894

UTM grid: 7322 5764

Elevation: 120 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 3.2 dunams (0.8 acre)

Topography: ridge edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 2 km distant

Visibility: 5

May 13, 1988; 49 shards

* * *

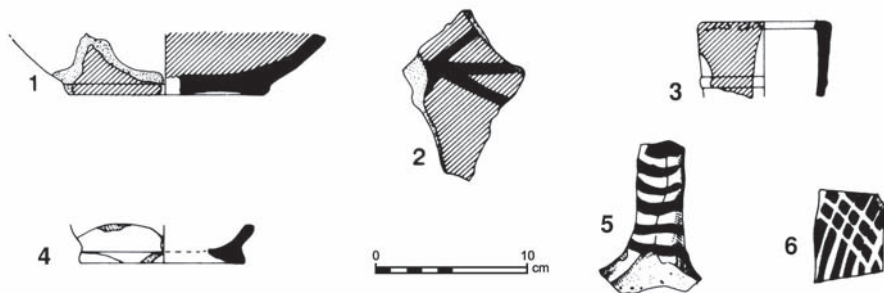
A large farm complex on the ridge edge overlooking the deep ravine of el-Hawakir, about 3 km south – southeast of Burj el-Malih.

At the site is an irregular shaped courtyard, 18x16.5 m in measurements, with rows of rooms along the eastern, southern and western wings. A cistern, which later became a cave, is in the southwestern corner of the yard. At least three built entrances are detected: in the north (a simple one) and the south

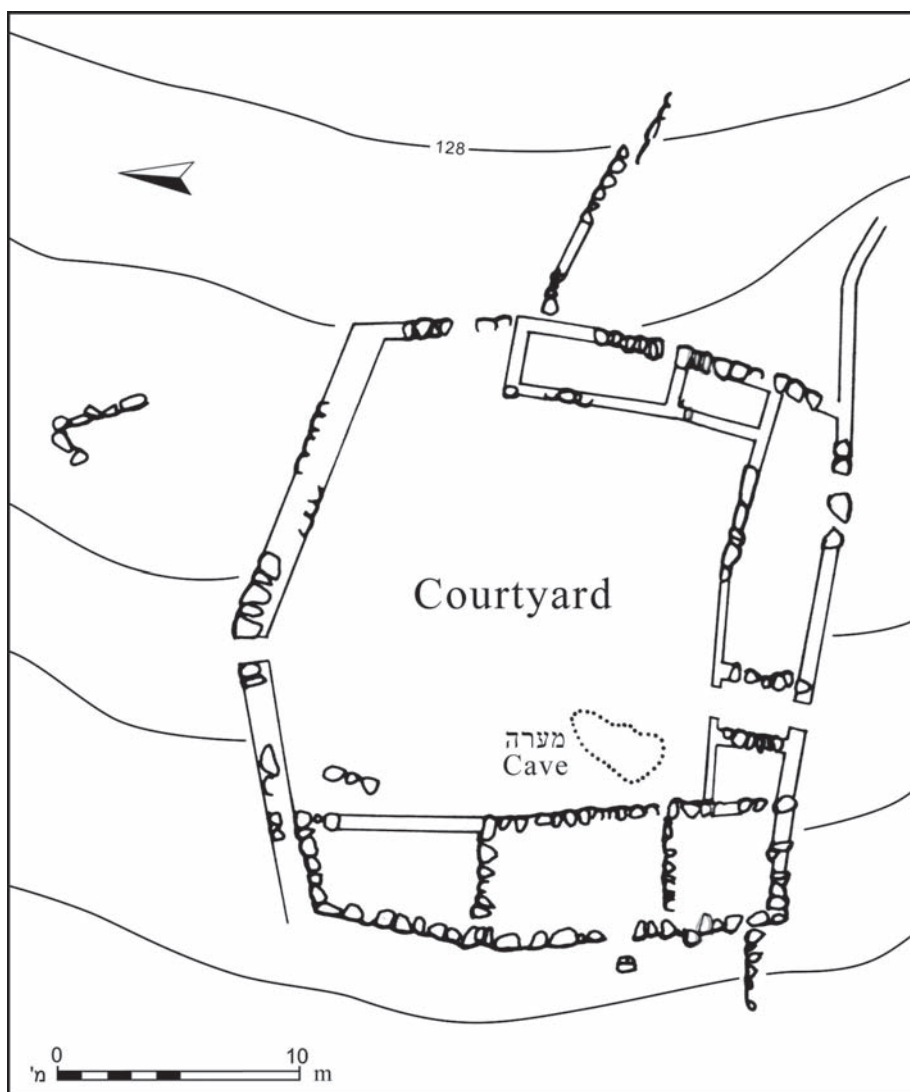
(an entrance between two rooms). A third entrance opens into the north – eastern room. The walls are of large field stones, with walls extend outwards from the court to the east. On a lower level below the yard is another enclosure, with no rooms (not on the plan). Outside the courtyard there are more cisterns.

Pottery: Byz – 80%; EM – 10%; MA – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



255. Pottery from el-Hawakir (B): 1-2. Bowls, red slip and white dec, MA; 3-4. Jar and bowl, br, Byz; 5-6. White dec on bl, EM.



256. Plan of the farm el-Hawakir (B). Note the yard with surrounding rooms and a cistern (cave) inside.

Site 113: 19 – 18/49/1

el-Hawakir (A)

Israel grid: 1942 1891

UTM grid: 7324 5761

Elevation: 125 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 0.8 dunam (0.2 acre)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 2 km distant

Visibility: 6

May 13, 1988; 19 shards

* * *

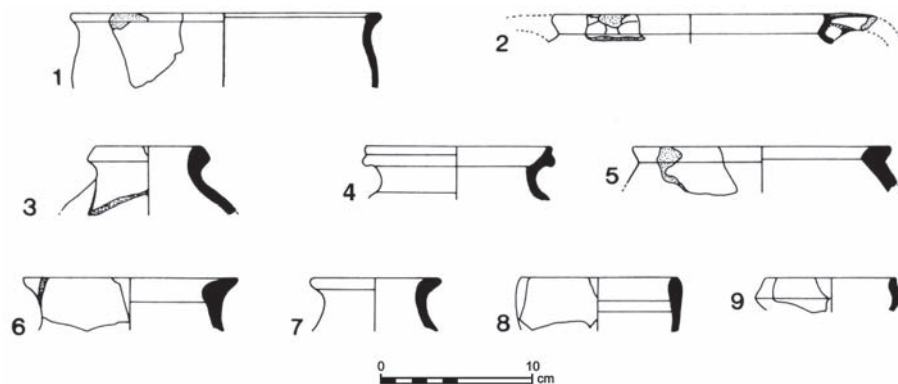
A small site on a high summit, west of Hawakir Valley and about 4.5 km south of Burj el-Malih.

There is a hewn cistern that appears on the 50:000 map, with a large pile of building stones next to it. These appear to have been taken

from a dismantled structure nearby. On the slope to the east are several walls and a considerable shard scatter.

Pottery: IrA II – 30%; Byz – 70%.

Previous surveys: none.



257. Pottery from el-Hawakir (A), nos. 1, 3, 5 – IrA II; 4,6-8 – Byz: 1. Bowl, br; 2. CP, LR; 3. Jar, gray; 4. Jug, lt br; 5. Bowl, br; 6-9. Jars, br and yel.

Site 114: 19 – 18/59/1

Khirbet Umm el-‘Uqbah (A) (on SWP map: Khurbet Umm el-Iqba; another name: Kh. Umm el-Kiba)

Israel grid: 1955 1899

UTM grid: 7337 5768

Elevation: 90 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: tell and large ruin

Area: 22 dunams (5.5 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: Kurnub formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 28

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa‘ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 0.8 km distant

Visibility: 6

Apr. 23, 1982; Mar. 30, 1990; 66 shards

* * *

A large ruin on a high, elongated range, west of and above Wadi el-Fau. About 0.5 km to the east runs the Beqa‘ot – Tel el-Hilu road.

On a large hilltop are many structures *in situ*, well built of large, hewn stones. Many caves were also found, with hewn, carved entrances into



258. The town of Kh. Umm el-‘Uqbah from the air, looking south. The site covers the conical shaped ridge, whose tip is in the east. At left are the slopes descending into Wadi el-Fau; at right is the saddle with many structures *in situ*.

the buildings and many cisterns. To the west of the hilltop, on a saddle, are two large structures (villas). The earlier stage compose of a 19x13 m hall with rooms. the later one, on top of the former, is a unit 20x10 m. It consists of a room with oven (?) and a paved courtyard. The few shards dating to Iron Age II are on the western slopes of the hill and on the narrow ridge east of the site.

This was a small town or a large village, that prospered during the LR and the Byzantine Periods, whose

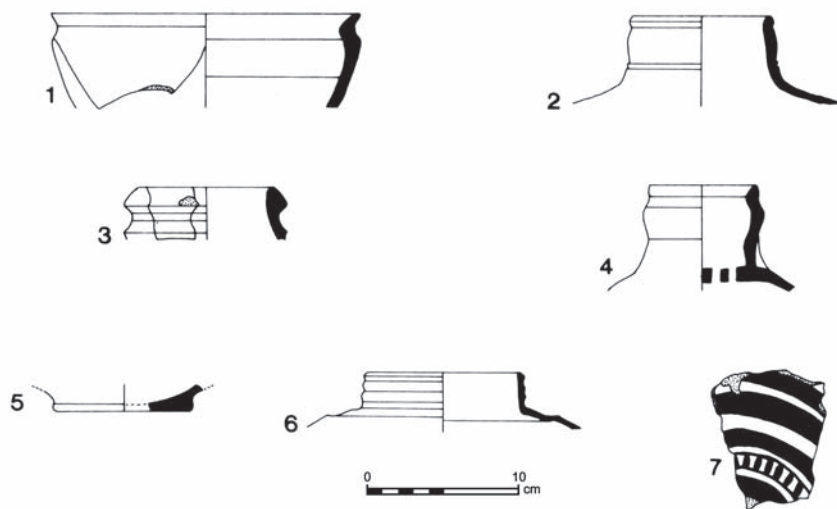
design and structures characterize the settlements of these periods in the desert fringes. Today the place is in advanced stages of destruction due to Israel Defense Force training, and looting of antiques.

Pottery: IrA II – 5%; LR – 30%; Byz – 65%.

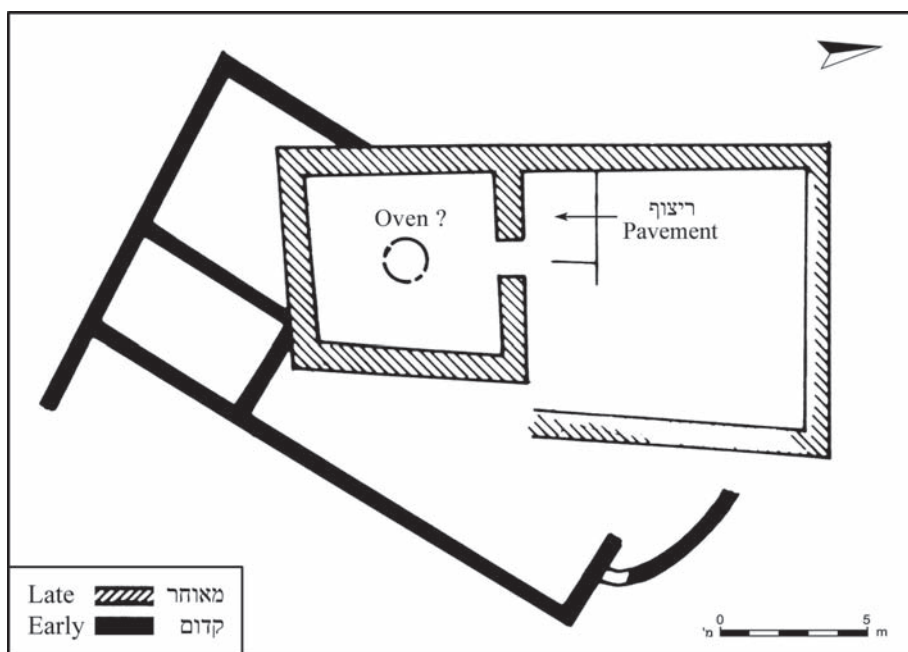
Coin finds: Ten coins from the Late Roman Period through the Middle Ages.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



259. Pottery from Khirbet Umm el-'Uqbeh (A): no. 3 – IrA II; 1-2, 4-6 – LR and Byz; 7 – MA: 1. Bowl, br; 2, 6 – Jars, lt br; 4. Jar with strainer, lt br; 5. Jar base, br; 7. Dec, br on wh.



260. Plan of a villa in Kh. Umm el-'Uqbeh (A), on the western saddle, showing its two stages.



261. Entrance to structure on the western saddle, looking south. Note the two doorposts *in situ*. 1990.

Site 115: 19 – 18/69/1

Khirbet Hamamat

Israel grid: 1962 1895

UTM grid: 7343 5765

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but does not appear on map

Site type: small ruin

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: ridge edge

Rock type: Kurnub formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 3 km distant

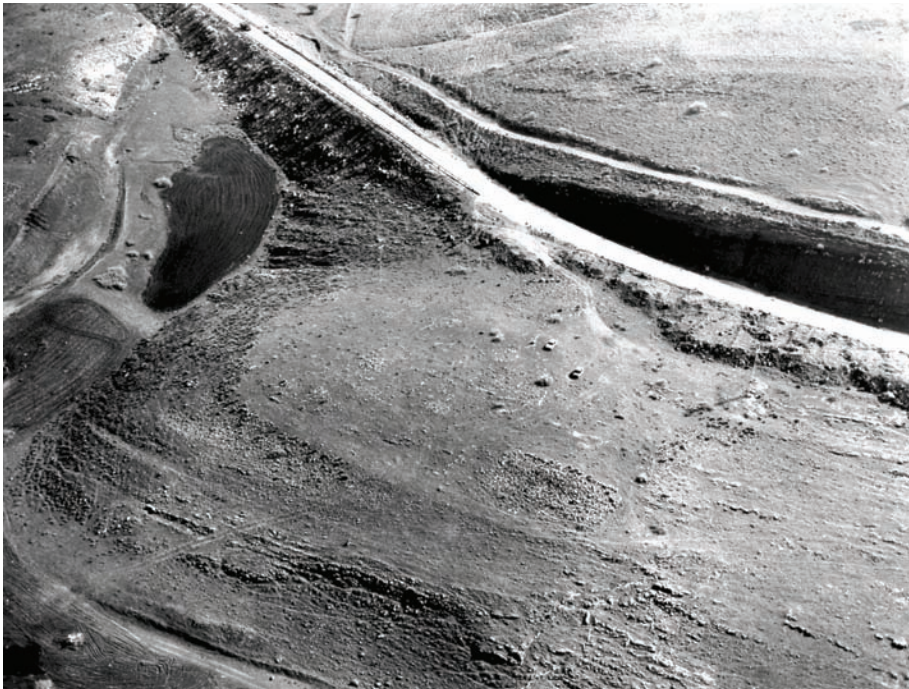
Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Apr. 29, 1988 – May 6, 1988; 59 shards

A site on a flat hilltop above Wadi el-Fau, near and west of the Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu road, and about 2.5 km north of Kh. es-Samrah.

At least ten structures were found in the site, relatively distant from one another. Most of them are located on the northern and western



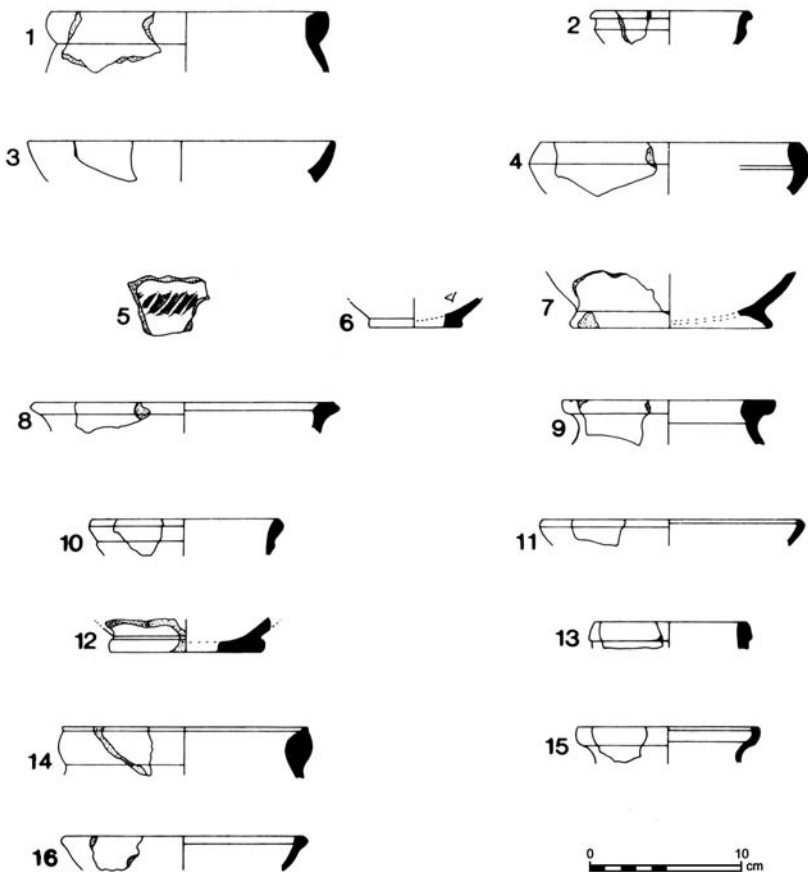
262. The site at Kh. Hamamat (indicated by cars), seen from the air and looking north. Road C23 (Beqa'ot – Meholah) is above and to the right of the site, while Wadi el-Fau is to its left. 1993.

parts of hilltop. Their walls, of large blocks of local sandstone, are 60 cm wide. The plans of the structures are complicated, with internal division into rooms and courtyards. In the south – western side of the settlement is a 26 m long wall covered with stones, possibly a part of fortification. In the northern side there are also remains of a possible wall.

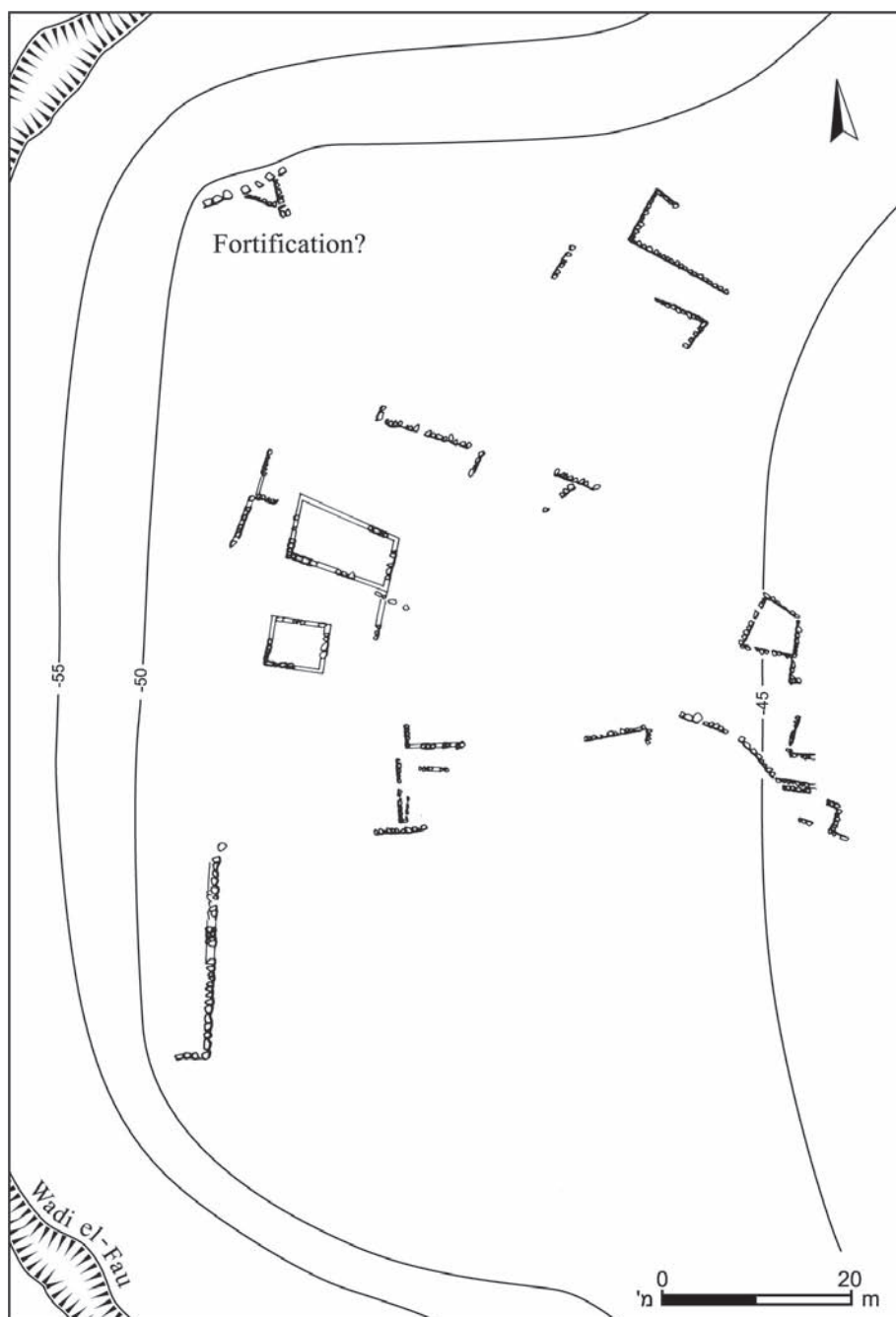
Pottery: EBA I – 5%; MBA IIB – 25%; LBA III – 40%; IrA IA – 30%.

The ceramic inventory is difficult to define. The place was possibly related to the nearby road and riverbed, which carries water during rainy winters.

Previous surveys: none.



263. Pottery from Kh. Hamamat: 2-3 – LB; 4, 6-12 – MBA II; 5 – EBA I ('Far'ah family?'); the rest – IrA I: 1. Pythos, dk; 2-3, Bowls, yel; 4. Bowl, lt br; 5. Rope dec, br; 6-7. Bowl bases, yel; 8-10. Jars, pinkish; 11. Bowl, lt; 12. Bowl, br; 13. Jug (?), br; 14. Pythos, dk br; 15. Jar, yel; 16. Bowl, lt.



264. The plan of the Hamamat site. It is in some way unique by plan (wide spaces between structures) and pottery.

Site 116: 19 – 18/38/1

el-Mubarah

Israel grid: 1933 1883

UTM grid: 7321 5763

Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure and farm

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: mountainous rendzina and
Mediterranean brown forest soil; qual-

ity: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-
Mayatteh, no. 86), 4 km distantNearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), 4 km distant

Visibility: 5

May 13, 1988; 10 shards

* * *

A structure on a high hilltop, about
4 km south of Wadi Malih.jacent courtyard were found related
to the structure.The structure is 10x10 m in size,
built of walls of field stones 1 m
wide. One opening and a small, ad-*Pottery*: Byz – 100%.*Previous surveys*: none.

Site 117: 19 – 18/47/1

Khirbet Yusef (on SWP map: Kh. Umm el-Hosr)

Israel grid: 1948 1879

UTM grid: 7335 5745

Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but not on map

Site type: large settlement

Area: 60 dunams (15 acres)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean
brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 5

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun
Hilu, no. 88), 6.5 km distantNearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

May 6, 1988; Apr. 14, 1990; 134
shards

* * *

A large settlement (a town?) in the
western edge of es-Samrah Val-
ley, an extension of the Buqe'ah,
about 3.5 km north – northwest of

Moshav Ro'i.

The site spread on a system of ar-
tificial terraces on a slope descend-
ing from the range of Umm Hasan

into es-Samrah Valley. On the terrace levels, dozens of structures are discerned *in situ*, some with walls standing to 2 m high. In the northern part is a round building 20 m in diameter, perhaps a lookout tower. Several pens and courtyards are located in the eastern and the western sides of the settlement, presumably from a later periods, perhaps the Middle Ages. In the northern, upper part a burial cave was found, with opening surrounded by an enclosure wall.

Most of the buildings are well

built of field stones, whereas the terraces are of large rock boulders. The ceramic finds are rich and varied.

Judging by its location and size, this was possibly a central site of the desert fringes during the Middle Bronze Age I-II.

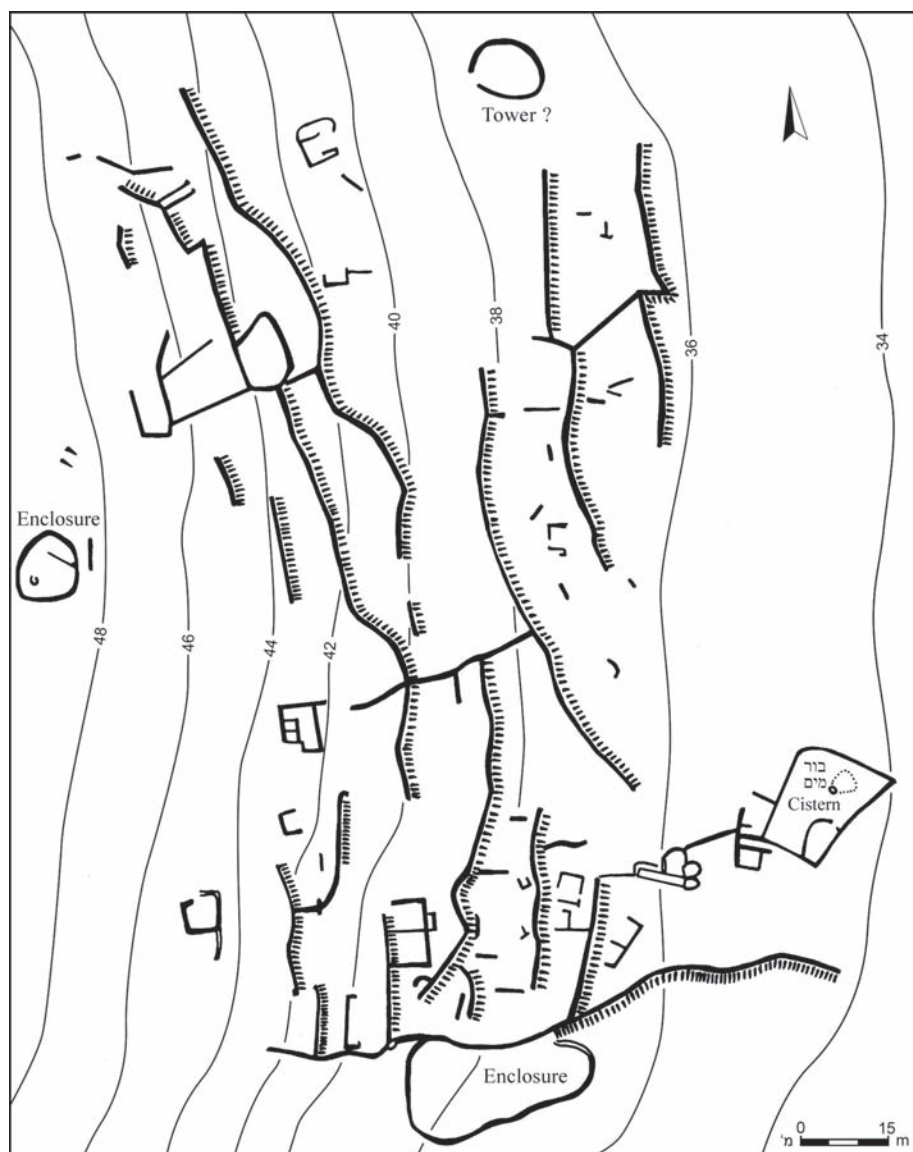
Pottery: Chal – 5%; EBA I – 5%; MBA I – 50%; MBA IIB – 15%; LBA III – 10%; IrA IA – 5%; MA – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.

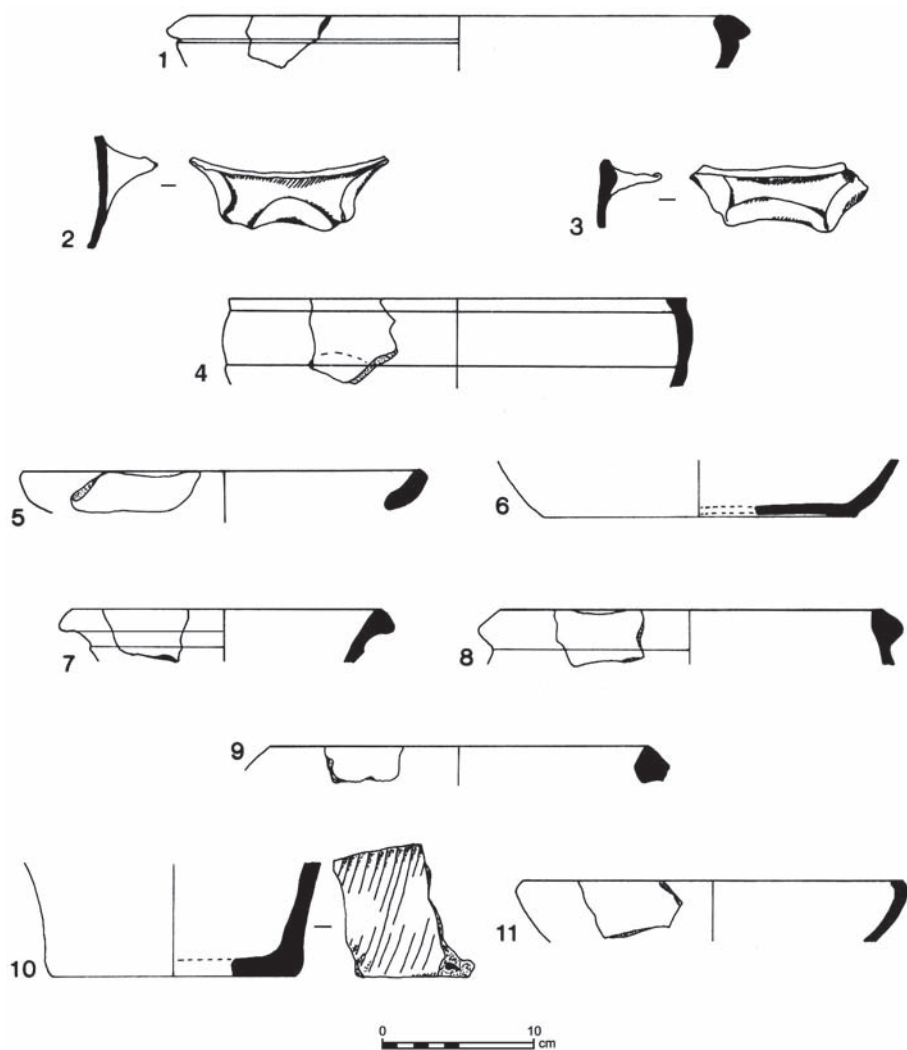
Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



265. Aerial photo of Kh. Yusef, looking west. 1993.



266. Plan of the large site at Kh. Yusef. It extends over terrace steps, most of which are built on ancient foundations. The courtyards and pens belong apparently to the Medieval Period.



267. Pottery from Kh. Yusef: nos 2-3, 6, 10 – MBA I; 1, 7, 9 – MBA II; 11 – LB; 5,8 – IrA I; 4 – MA: 1. Crater, Yel; 2-3. Ledge handles, lt; 4. Bowl, br; 5. Bowl, lt br; 6. Jar base, yel; 7. Jar, pinkish; 8. Crater, br; 9. CP, dk br; 10. Jar base with imprint dec; 11. Bowl, lt.

Site 118: 19 – 18/46/1

E.P. 170

Israel grid: 1948 1868

UTM grid: 7328 5738

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: high hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa‘ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 2 km distant

Visibility: 7

Nov. 12, 1993; 17 shards

* * *

A small site on a high summit southwest of Kh. Yusef and north of the Buqe‘ah, about 1 km east of Kh. Mushebiq. There is a fine view from there of the Buqe‘ah and of Wadi el-Fau.

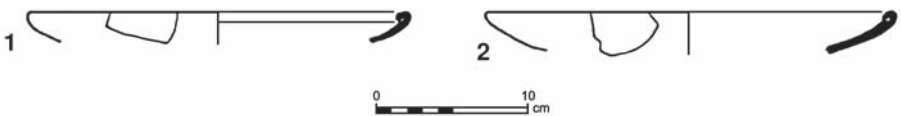
At least two structures are on the summit. They consist of walls of structures *in situ*, covered by cleared stones. Around is a medium sized shard scatter. The ceramic inven-

tory include Middle Bronze Age II shallow bowls with folded rims; see chapter on ceramics.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 88%; IrA I (not certain) – 12%.

The single vessel type found may hint toward a special function of the site. The two bases of bowls are perhaps from Iron Age I.

Previous surveys: none.



268. Pottery from E.P. 170: Two typical bowls from MBA IIB. This is almost the only type of bowl found at this site.

CHAPTER NINE

THE BUQEI'AH

LANDSCAPE UNIT 17



Traditional springtime harvesting
(source unknown)

Site 119: 18 – 18/88/1

en-Naqqar (A)

Israel grid: 1888 1883

UTM grid: 7270 5752

Elevation: 230 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 5

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa‘ot junction (C20), passes by site

Visibility: 3

March 10, 1982; 64 shards

* * *

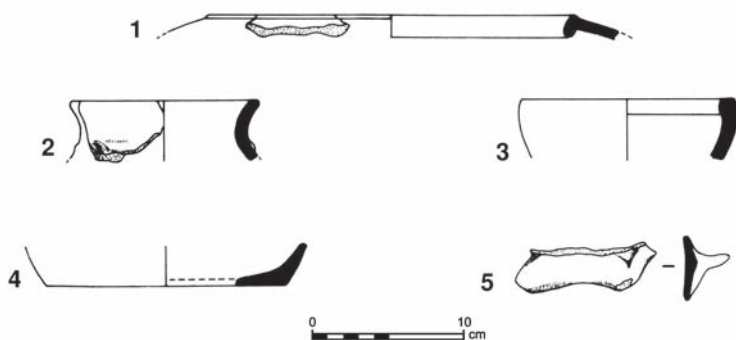
A site on the northwestern fringe of the Buqe‘ah, with the dirt road from Tammun to Moshav Beqa‘ot nearby. From the site is a view of the Buqe‘ah and to the other MBA I sites nearby.

The site is located above Wadi Durah, which drains the Buqe‘ah to the east. On a low step are remains of many structures *in situ*, square in shape and having an at-

tached courtyard. Most of the houses are arranged from east to west in a strip (the so-called “strip settlements”), but few are on the natural steps descending into the valley. Some of the structures are built of especially large stones, and various installations and shards are scattered around.

Pottery: MBA I – 95%; MA – 5%.

Previous surveys: none.



269. Pottery from the Middle Bronze Age I site of en-Naqqar (A), all from this period except for no. 3: 1. HM jar, yel; 2. Jar, gray; 3. Bowl with yellow glaze, MA; 4. Jar base, gray; 5. Folded ledge handle, yel.

Site 120: 18 – 18/98/1

en-Naqqar (B)

Israel grid: 1890 1884

UTM grid: 7272 5752

Elevation: 230 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 4

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa‘ot junction (C20), passes by site

Visibility: 3

March 10, 1982; 51 shards

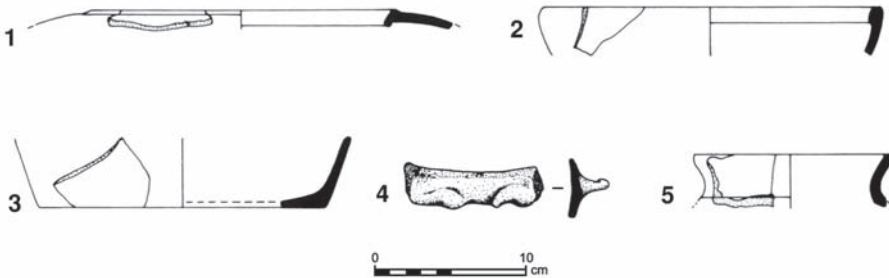
A site on the northwestern fringes of the Buqe‘ah, located slightly west of the Tammun – Beqa‘ot dirt road and 2 km east – northeast of Tammun.

The site is on a low step near Wadi Durah, which drains the Buqe‘ah to the east. About 0.2 km west of it is en-Naqqar (A). It appears that the buildings in the site

were dismantled during the process of cultivation. The only structure remained is in the east, near the dirt road going north to Tubas Valley. Few shards are beside it, with shards scatter over the other parts of the place.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



270. Shards from en-Naqqar (B), all from MBA I: 1. HM jar, yel; 2. Bowl, lt gray; 3. Jar Base, yel; 4. Ledge handle, yel; 5. Jar, dk gray.

Site 121: 19 – 18/18/1

Beyader Shawish

Israel grid: 1912 1884

UTM grid: 7294 5752

Elevation: 175 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Kurnub formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 8

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot junction (C20), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar 31, 1982; 20 shards

* * *

A small site on the northern edge of the Buqeī'ah, between the wadis Beyader Shawish and Khallet Ramali.

Several walls of field stones on top of a low terrace are on the site,

with no clear plans. Few shards are scattered among the walls, with more in the field to the south.

The site includes several structures, presumably seasonal enclosures or pens. Similar structures



271. The Beyader Shawish site (northern edge of the Buqeī'ah), looking north. The walls are on the edge of the valley; in the background the eastern extensions of Ras Jadir are visible. 1982.

are today in use by Bedouins. The northern edge of the Buqe'ah is less amenable to passage than the southern one, where ancient roads

passed.

Pottery: IrA II – 80%; Byz – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 122: 18 – 18/67/1

Tammun (also on SWP map)

Israel grid: 1864 1878

UTM grid: 7257 5750

Elevation: 370 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: Arab village on map

Site type: large Arab village

Area: 40 dunams (10 acres – the ancient core)

Topography: hilltop and ridge edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 80

Nearest water source: spring (Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 6

Mar. 12, 1982; 90 shards

A large Arabic village on a hilltop at the edge of a ridge, overlooking an inner valley to the west and the Buqe'ah to the east. It is crowned, to the south, by high Jebel Tammun.

The central village is a tell, whose remains are blurred now. The ancient core of the modern village is a part of the tell. This core includes Medieval fortified houses with loopholes for shooting. Many burial caves were also found, as well as hewn places, installations and parts of ancient walls.

Pottery: IrA II – 10%; ER – 10%; LR – 20%; Byz – 20%; EM – 10%; MA – 20%; Ott – 10%.

In the Medieval literature the vil-

lage was wrongly identified with biblical *Tappuah* (Jos 17:7-8), on the Manasseh – Ephraim boundary. It appears as the “Land of *Tappuah*” or *Terrae Tampne*. The monk Burchard of Mount Zion (1280 C.E.) wrote: “Six leagues east of *Tirzah*, on the road leading to Jordan, is the Land of *Tappuah* which, of all the mountains, is outstanding as an exceptionally bare mountain [the reference is to Jebel Tammun, A.Z.]. This area is also the territory of Manasseh, reaching to the plains of the Jordan opposite Macherunte.” (probably *Machaerus* of Josephus, a fort in Transjordan involved in the first revolt against the Romans, A.Z.). The Land of *Tappuah*, according to him, is along

the southern border of Manasseh. Later the place is mentioned by the 14th century Italian explorer Marino Sanuto (1321 C.E.) as “*Terrae Tampne*, bordering the allotment of Ephraim in the north.”

Guérin visited the village on April 25, 1870, and found there “ancient cisterns and cellars”. He wrote that

only the hilltop was settled, while the slopes were covered with piles of trash.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: SWP II, 228; Guérin 1969 (IV), 257; Beyer 1940, 189; Burchard 1971, 52; Sanutu 1971, 13.



272. The village Tammun from the air, looking north. The ancient tell is in the center and beyond the village the road to Tubas is seen.

Site 123: 18 – 18/87/2

el-Khanuq

Israel grid: 1885 1874

UTM grid: 7273 5756

Elevation: 240 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa‘ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Mar. 10, 1982; 42 shards

* * *

A site on the western fringes of the Buqe‘ah, about 2 km east of the village of Tammun. Located in a small valley near a wadi named el-Khanuq, it descends from the Tam-

mun plateau to the Buqe‘ah. Nearby a built path leads from Kh. ‘Atuf to Tammun.

A very large pile of stones, apparently including the building stones



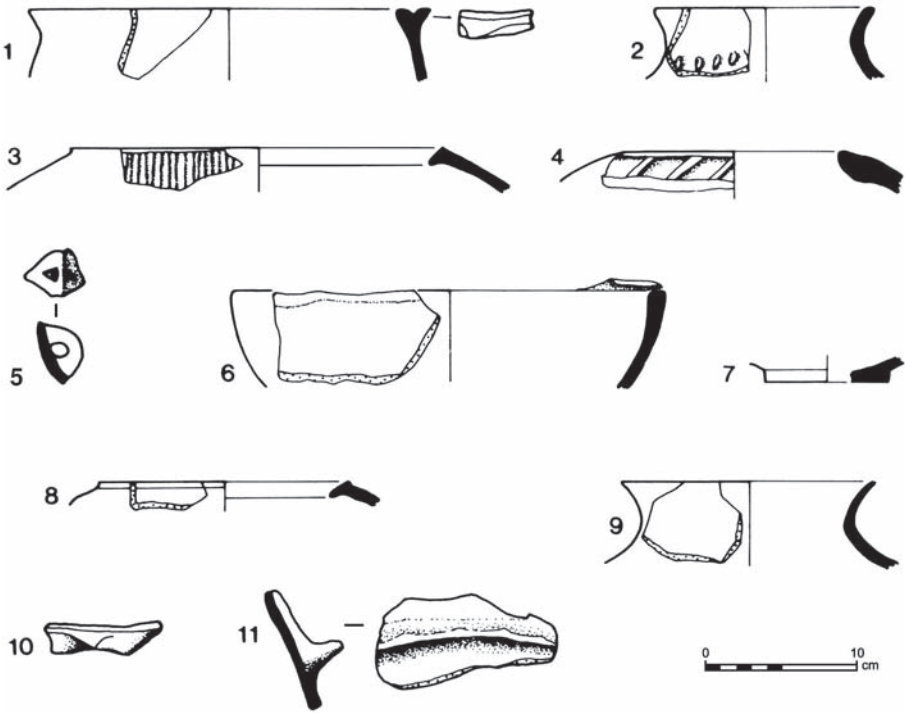
273. The Middle Bronze Age I site of el-Khanuq on the western edge of the Buqe‘ah, looking north. The location, on a low slope protected from the wind, is typical of the “fringes sites” of the Buqe‘ah. Remains of the site are visible near the piles of stone on the far side of the ravine.

of the dismantled structures, is in the center of the site. The pile is surrounded by a stone fence, with many shards scattered in the areas

around.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



274. Pottery from el-Khanuq, all from MBA I: 1. Bowl, yel; 2. Jar, dk gray; 3. HM jar with cut rim, gray, stamped dec; 4. HM jar, brown, rope dec; 5. Flat loophole handle, yel; 6. Bowl with irregular rim, gray; 7. Bowl base in MBA II tradition; 8. HM jar, yel; 9. Jar, dk gray; 10-11. Ledge handles, yel.

Site 124: 18 – 18/87/1

Abu Rihan

Israel grid: 1886 1872

UTM grid: 7273 5754

Elevation: 240 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa‘ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

Mar. 10, 1982; may 5, 2006; 99 shards

* * *

A small site on the western fringes of the Buqei‘ah, about 2 km east of the village of Tammun. North of the site is a small gorge (Khanuq), with a built path to Tammun.

New terrace walls, built of stones of the ancient site, are the sole ar-

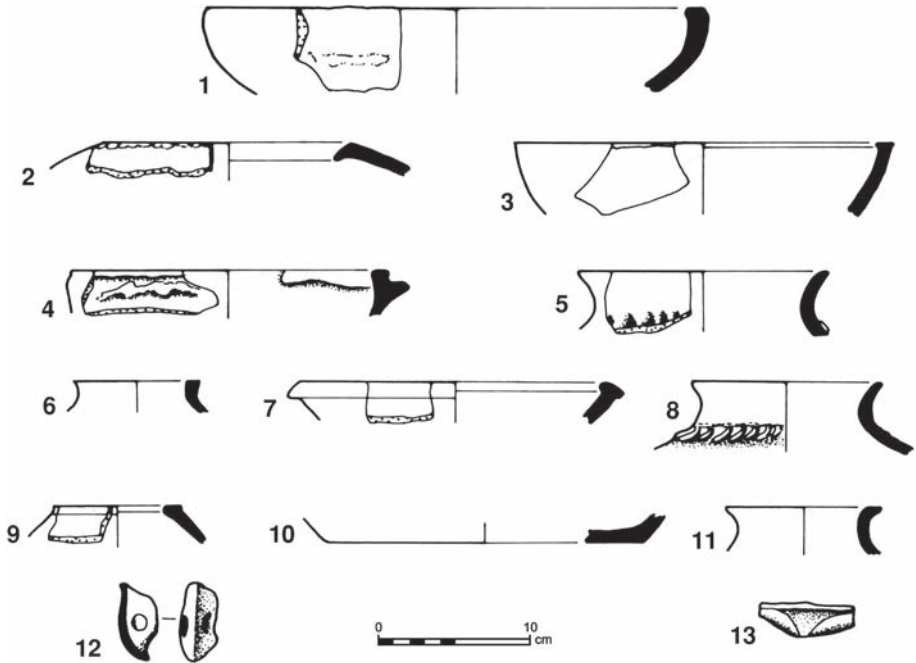
chitecture. The original structures have been dismantled through preparation for agriculture, and a large quantity of shards is scattered around.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



275. The site of Abu Rihan, looking south, is situated on the opposite slope. Jebel Tammun is in the far background.



276. Pottery from Abu Rihan, all from MBA I: 1, 3. Bowls, yel and br; 2. HM jar, gray; 4. Bowl with irregular rim, br; 5, 8. Jars, gray, rope dec; 6. Jar, yel; 7. Bowl, yel; 9. HM jar, yel; 10. Jar base, yel; 11. Jar, gray; 12. Loop handle, yel; 13. Folded ledge handle.



Site 125: 18 – 18/87/3

Bir ej-Jwar

Israel grid: 1888 1870

UTM grid: 7270 5737

Elevation: 220 m a.s.l., 7 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: medium sized ruin

Area: 9.8 dunams (2.45 acres)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: springs ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar. 4, 1982; 111 shards

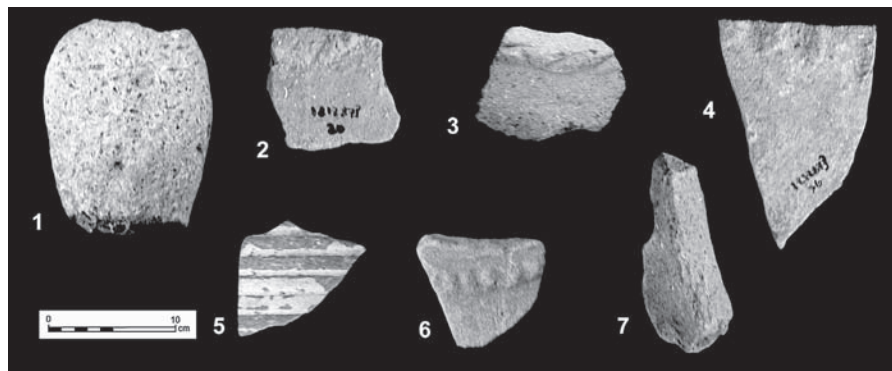
A site on the western fringe of the Buqe'ah, north of Jebel Tammun and about 2.5 km east of the village

of Tammun. It is situated on a ridge protected by wadi gorges, with an ancient well (Bir ej-Jwar) in its cen-

ter. An important junction of paths is nearby.

A low terrace marks the perimeter of the site. It should have been used as a borderline and perhaps a

fortification. Inside are numerous terraces and cultivated areas, with no structural remains. The terraces seems to be built on top of ancient walls. A large shard scatter was found.



277. Photos of pottery from Bir ej-Jwar site. no.2, 5 – Byz; 1-4, 6-7 – MBA I.



278. View to the north of the large MBA I site at Bir ej-Jwar, on the western edge of the Buqei'ah. The site, isolated from its close environs by gorges, is in the center of the ridge, above the jeep. In the background Ras Jadir is visible.

The place appears to be a central site for the settlements in the Buqeï'ah.

Pottery: MBA I – 90%; Byz – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 126: 19 – 18/37/1

Ras el-Ahmar

Israel grid: 1930 1875

UTM grid: 7323 5745

Elevation: 240 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Kurnub formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa‘ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 7

Mar. 31, 1982; Mar. 22, 1993; 17 shards



279. View to the Buqeï'ah, seen from Ras el-Ahmar. Note the enclosure (with the figure), Moshav Beqa‘ot (in the distance, at center) and the ranges of Umm Jurein in the background.

An enclosure on a high slope above the northern edge of the Buqei'ah, with a fine view to the valley. Wadi Nis descends nearby.

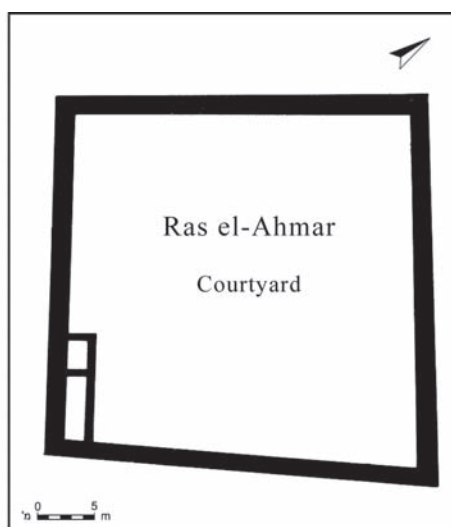
A square enclosure, about 33x33 m in size, is the core of the site. It is surrounded by a stone wall about 1.5 m wide. It is well built of two rows of stones with a filling of field stones between them. In the southeast corner of the enclosure a

long, narrow structure is attached, with two rooms. The entrance was not found.

This is one of many structures (enclosures or courtyards) characteristic of the desert fringe area. It seems to have been used for agricultural purposes.

Pottery: LR – 20%; Byz – 80%.

Previous surveys: none.



280. Right – plan of the courtyard at Ras el-Ahmar. Left – place of the courtyard on the mountain of Ras el-Ahmar.

Site 127: 19 – 18/36/2

Khirbet Musheibik (on SWP map: Kh. Umm esh-Sheibik)

Israel grid: 1935 1869

UTM grid: 7316 5739

Elevation: 216 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: medium sized ruin and farm

Area: 7 dunams (1.75 acres)

Topography: hilltop and plateau

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 7

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6.1 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa‘ot junction (C20), 1 km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar. 31, 1982; Apr. 10, 1988; Mar.

16, 1990; 84 shards

* * *

A farm complex on a low summit, part of the Umm Hasan range; this belongs to the high northern edge of the Buqeī'ah.

The site, a relatively well preserved, includes the following (fig. 282):

1. The central core is a square

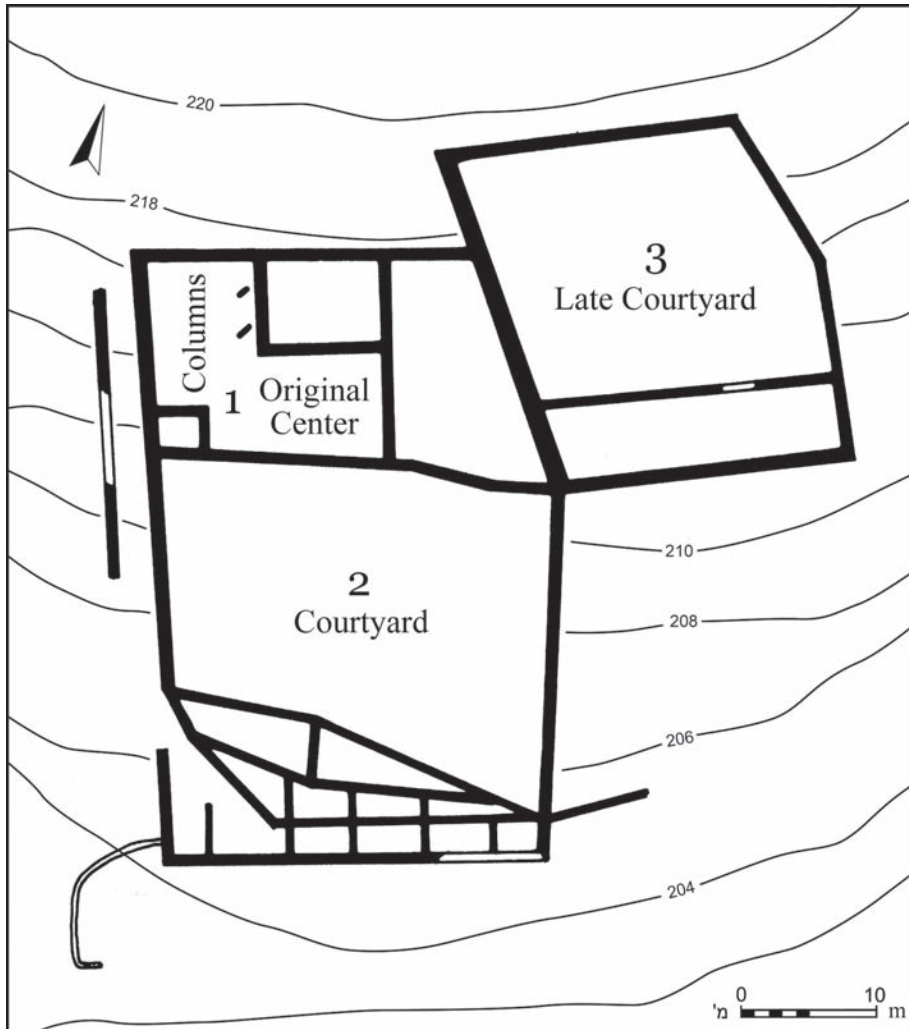


281. The Iron Age/Byzantine/Moslem Periods farm of Kh. Musheibik, looking southwest. The original core of the farm is in the upper right corner; during various periods courtyards were added to it.

courtyard, 15x18 m in size, in the northwest, upper corner of the complex. Inside it is the main house (in the northeast corner), with large stone pillars (*monoliths*) *in situ* to support the roof. In the southwest corner of the courtyard is another, small structure.

2. South of no. 1 is a large courtyard, 25x30 m in size. Its southern edge is a strip with many walls and rooms, whose character is unclear. This courtyard seems to be contemporary with no. 1 and precedes no. 3.

3. The third large courtyard



282. Plan of the Kh. Musheibik farm. Note the assumed stages of development of the site: 1. Central core from IrA II (?); 2. Attached courtyard and structures nearby; 3. Later courtyard.

(25x25 m), with different orientation, is built in the northeast corner. It seems to be later than nos. 1-2, perhaps to be added during later periods (Byzantine or Early Moslem).

4. About 80 m northwest of the complex, beyond the saddle, is another, irregular shaped courtyard about 30x30 m in size. It is built with two rows of large stones. Inside are a cave and a small structure. This yard, seemingly for agricultural use, is similar to the characteristic yards of the region.

5. Some 0.3-0.5 km to the east of the farm, on a high ridge, are stone

towers and agricultural terraces.

Kh. Mushiebib is a fine example of a farm established in Iron Age II-III, to be continued in later periods. It includes the farm itself and its agricultural surroundings.

Pottery: IrA II – 50%; IrA III – 20%; Byz – 20%; EM – 10% (a single Medial shard).

Special find: Bowls with wedge decoration.

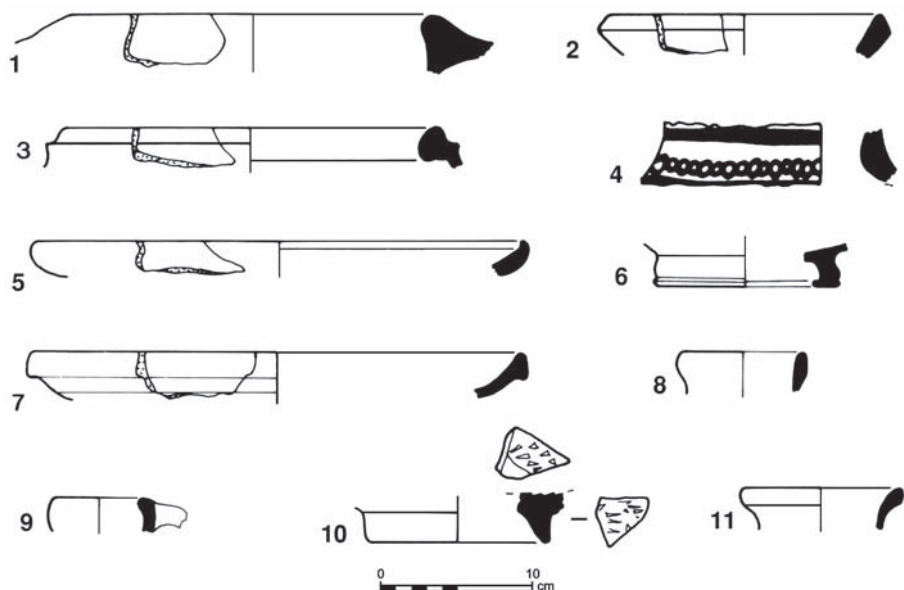
Coin find: One coin from the 12th century C.E.; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: SWP II, 242.



283. Remains of the Kh. Musheibik farm, looking west. Ras Jadir is in the background.



284. Pottery from Kh. Musheibik: 1. CP, br, IrA II; 2. Bowl, br, IrA II-III; 3. CP type D, IrA II; 4. Dec jar, violet on wh, MA; 5. Bowl, br, IrA III; 6. Bowl base, br, Byz; 7. Bowl, br, IrA III; 8-9. Jugs, IrA II; 10. Bowl base with wedge dec, gray, IrA III; 11. Jug, lt br, Byz.



Site 128: 19 – 18/67/2

es-Samrah Enclosure

Israel grid: 1964 1872

UTM grid: 7345 5744

Elevation: 50 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: valley and ridge

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

Visibility: 3

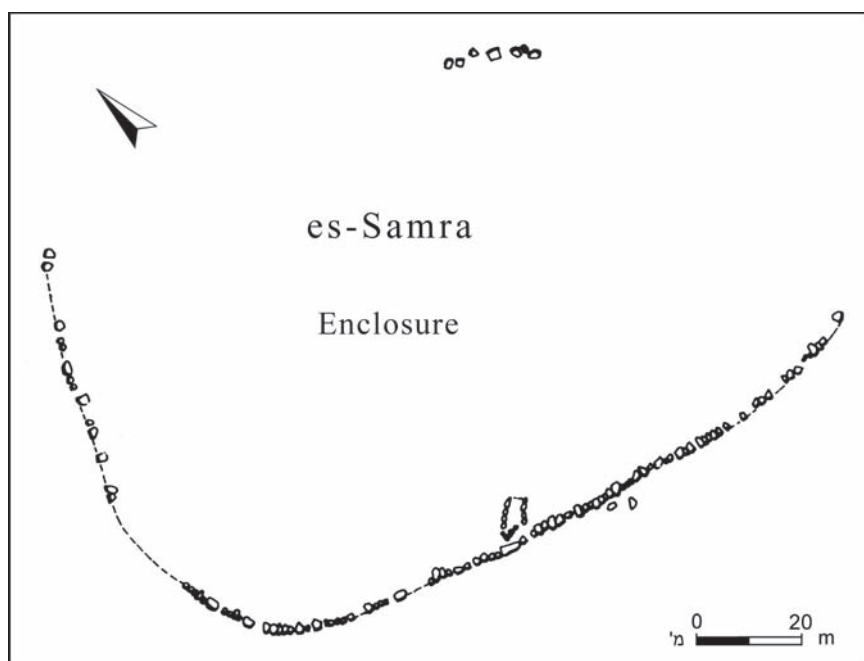
Apr. 22-29, 1988; 19 shards

A large enclosure on a low ridge in the northern edge of the Buqei'ah. The site is situated half way be-

tween Beqa'ot and Tel el-Hilu, and about 0.3 km northwest of Kh. es-Samrah.



285. The southern enclosure wall at es-Samrah, looking north. In the background are the Umm el-'Uqbeh ranges.



286. The enclosure plan at es-Samrah.